Cranberry Models: Common Control

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1) Introduction

Crop production and harvest is an area of study whose output affects every general population. This is becuase everyone, regardless of their different facets of life - need to consume food to survive. With the growing trend of global temperature, food production and harvest quantity may fluctuate.

This study aims answer question about the effects of heat treatment to cranberries and result we observe in production of cranberries.

We aim of answer the following questions :

1. How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the total weight of fruit?
2. How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the total weight of healthy fruit?
3. How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the percentage of healthy berries by count?
4. How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the percentage of healthy fruit by weight?
5. How do the cultivars, years, and intensity of the heat shocks (in the case of the acute heat stress experiment) affect the various measures of yield?

2) Data and Experimental Design

Experimental design. The data contain 96 plots of two cranberry cultivars, Mullica Queen and Stevens, each grown in its own field, in 2024 and 2025. The plots form 48 pairs of neighbouring plots: in each pair, one plot was heated and the other was left unheated as a Control. Heated plots received 1, 2, 3 or 4 heat pulses (intensity groups D, C, B and A in the data), with 3 pairs for each number of pulses in every combination of cultivar and year. All Control plots received the same treatment, whatever happened to their paired heated plot, so we treat the 12 Control plots of each cultivar and year as one Control group. The heat treatment therefore has five levels: Control and 1, 2, 3 or 4 pulses.

Yield measures. For each plot, the data record the number and weight of healthy and rotten berries. From these we calculated the four measures of yield studied in this report: total fruit weight (healthy plus rotten weight), healthy fruit weight, the percentage of healthy berries by count, and the percentage of healthy fruit by weight.

Data checks. The data have no missing values. Every pair contains exactly one Control and one heated plot, and all weights and berry counts are positive. No observations were removed, so all analyses use the full 96 plots.

Paired design. The two plots of a pair are neighbours and share soil and growing conditions, so their yields are not independent. All models in this report therefore include a random effect for each pair, which allows each pair to have its own baseline yield.

First look at the data. Control yields were similar in three of the four combinations of cultivar and year, but Stevens produced only about a third as much fruit in 2025 ([Table: control means]). To put all plots on a common scale, [Figure: overview] expresses each plot as a percentage of the mean Control value of its own cultivar and year, with both cultivars shown together. Most heated groups had a lower average yield than Control. For the two weights, the clearest reductions occurred with three or four pulses in 2025, whereas in

2024 there was no clear pattern with the number of pulses. For the two percentages, the share of healthy fruit was lower in every heated group, by a broadly similar amount whatever the number of pulses. Plots varied widely within each group, and many heated plots overlapped with Control plots, so the models in Sections 3 to 6 are needed to judge which differences are reliable.

Table 1: Mean of each yield measure in the Control plots, by cultivar and year.

Cultivar	Year	Total (g)	Healthy (g)	Healthy, % by count	Healthy, % by weight
Mullica Queen	2024	1091	1060	95.8	97.1
Mullica Queen	2025	1096	1057	94.5	96.4
Stevens	2024	961	945	95.6	98.4
Stevens	2025	379	374	95.2	98.9

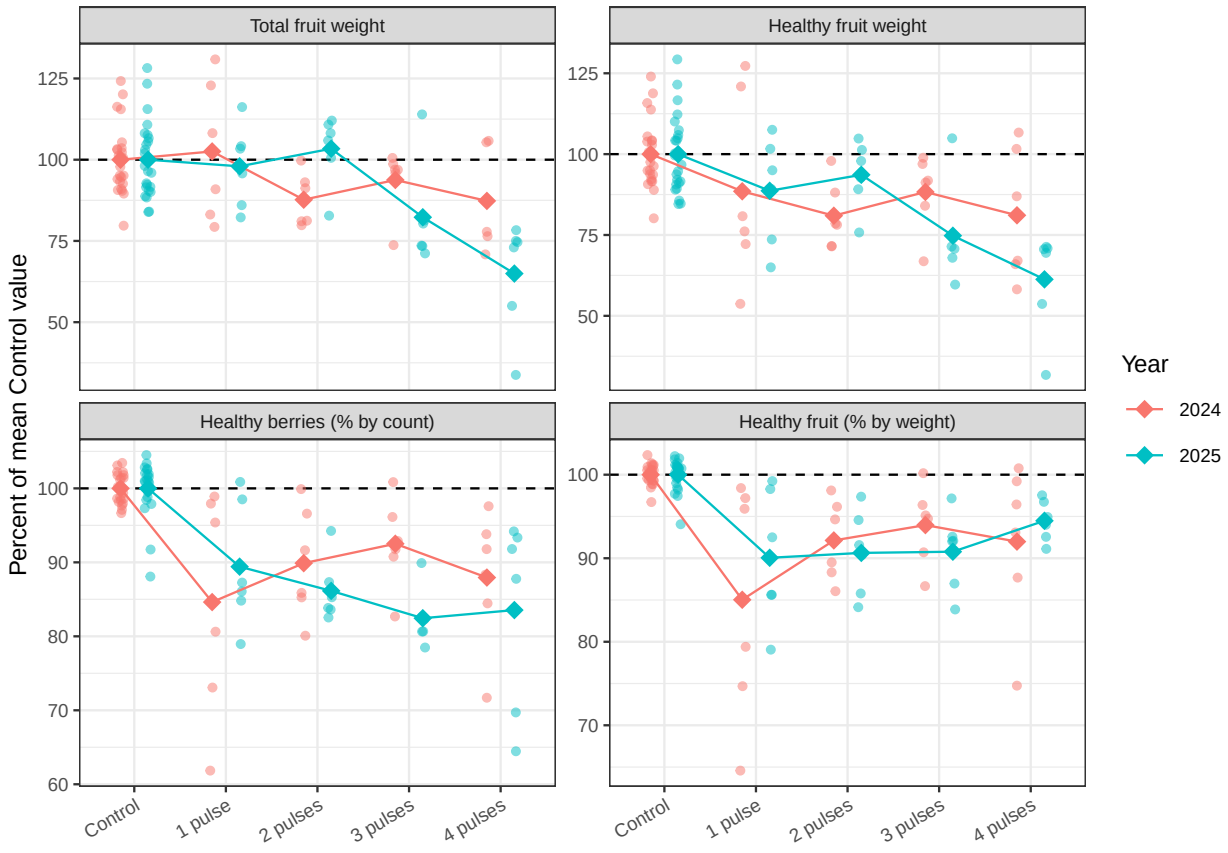


Figure 1: Each yield measure as a percentage of the mean of the Control plots of the same cultivar and year, with both cultivars combined. Small points are individual plots; diamonds joined by lines are group means, coloured by year. The dashed line at 100 marks the Control level. Vertical scales differ between panels.

3) How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the total weight of fruit?

Section 2 examines the distribution of total weight and the pair structure, and Appendix A compares the candidate models. The fitted model has heat group by year, cultivar, and the cultivar-by-year shift in its fixed part, a random intercept for each pair, and separate residual variances for Control and heated plots.

3.1 Final model

The final model for plot i is

$$\log(Y_i) = \mu + \alpha_{g(i)} + \beta_{t(i)} + (\alpha\beta)_{g(i)\,t(i)} + \gamma_{c(i)} + (\beta\gamma)_{t(i)\,c(i)} + b_{k(i)} + \varepsilon_i,$$

where Y_i is the total fruit weight in grams and log is the natural logarithm. μ is the overall intercept, α_g the effect of heat group g, β_t the effect of year t, γ_c the effect of cultivar c, $(\alpha\beta)_{gt}$ the heat-by-year interaction, and $(\beta\gamma)_{tc}$ the cultivar-by-year shift. b_k is the random intercept of pair k, with $b_k \sim N(0, \sigma_b^2)$, and ε_i is the residual error, with variance $\sigma^2_{\text{Control}}$ in Control plots and σ^2_{Heated} in heated plots. The estimated standard deviations are $\hat{\sigma}_b = 0.067$, $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Control}} = 0.09$ and $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Heated}} = 0.164$. The model was fitted by restricted maximum likelihood in R with nlme.

3.2 Coefficients of the final model

Table 2: Fixed-effect estimates of the final heteroscedastic H2 model.

Term	Estimate	SE	p_value	Ratio	Lower_95	Upper_95
(Intercept)	6.987	0.031	< 1e-04	1082.535	1016.681	1152.654
heat_groupD	-0.006	0.072	0.93396	0.994	0.859	1.150
heat_groupC	-0.140	0.072	0.05976	0.870	0.752	1.006
heat_groupB	-0.044	0.072	0.54507	0.957	0.827	1.107
heat_groupA	-0.135	0.072	0.06883	0.874	0.755	1.011
year2025	-0.012	0.044	0.79197	0.988	0.904	1.080
cultivarST	-0.121	0.042	0.00636	0.886	0.814	0.965
heat_groupD:year2025	0.001	0.102	0.99550	1.001	0.814	1.230
heat_groupC:year2025	0.160	0.102	0.12503	1.173	0.955	1.442
heat_groupB:year2025	-0.167	0.102	0.10883	0.846	0.688	1.040
heat_groupA:year2025	-0.321	0.102	0.00311	0.725	0.590	0.891
year2025:cultivarST	-0.906	0.060	< 1e-04	0.404	0.358	0.456

Control, 2024 and Mullica Queen are the reference levels. A `heat_group` coefficient is the log ratio of total weight in that heat group to Control in 2024 for Mullica Queen. A `:year2025` term is the additional change in 2025, `cultivarST` is the Stevens minus Mullica Queen difference in 2024, and `year2025:cultivarST` is the extra 2025 change for Stevens.

3.3 Predicted yields

The figure below shows the fitted mean total fruit weight for each heat group, cultivar and year, with 95% confidence intervals. In 2024 the four heat groups sit close to Control. In 2025 the estimate falls from Control to four pulses. Mullica Queen has the higher baseline, so the same proportional fall is the larger loss in grams.

3.4 Answer

Heat stress lowers total fruit weight, but how big the drop is depends on the year and on how many pulses the plants get. On average, the four heat levels are about 11.5% lower than Control. The drop is smaller in 2024 (about 7.8%) and larger in 2025 (about 15.1%). In 2025, A is about 36.6% lower and B about 19.1% lower. Each pulse trend points are about −9% per pulse overall, but it is weak in 2024 (−3%, p = 0.36)

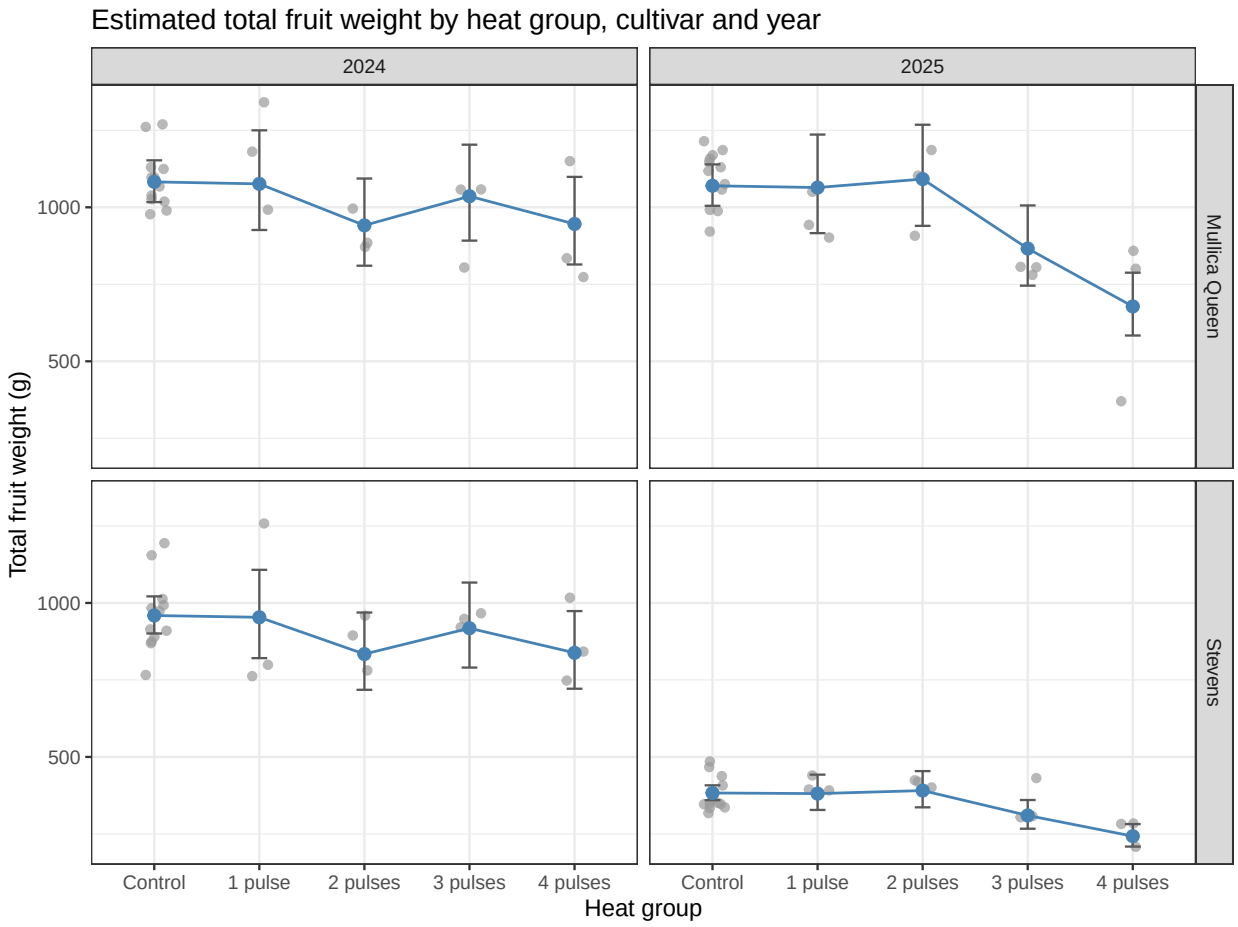


Figure 2: Estimated total fruit weight by heat group, cultivar (rows) and year (columns). Blue points are the means estimated by the final model, joined by lines, with 95% confidence intervals shown as bars; grey points are the individual plots. Control and heated plots are allowed different residual variances, so the intervals of heated plots are wider.

and strong in 2025 (−15%, $p < 0.0001$). We do not see a heat × cultivar interaction for p=0.28; MQ and ST differ mostly in baseline, and the 2025 ST baseline is much lower. We also let Control and OTC have different residual variances; the LRT supports this, so we use that model for the final estimates.

4) How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the total weight of healthy fruit?

4.1 First look

Comparing each heated plot with its own Control. [Figure: log ratio] shows the ratio of healthy fruit weight between each heated plot and its neighbouring Control plot. In 37 of the 48 pairs (77%), the heated plot produced less healthy fruit than its Control, so heat reduced healthy weight in most pairs. The pattern across heat intensities differed between years. In 2024, the ratios were similar for all four intensities: in most groups, heated plots produced about 15 to 25% less healthy fruit than their Controls, and there was no tendency for more pulses to cause a larger reduction. In 2025, the ratios decreased as the number of heat pulses increased, and heated plots that received three or four pulses produced clearly less healthy fruit than those that received one or two.

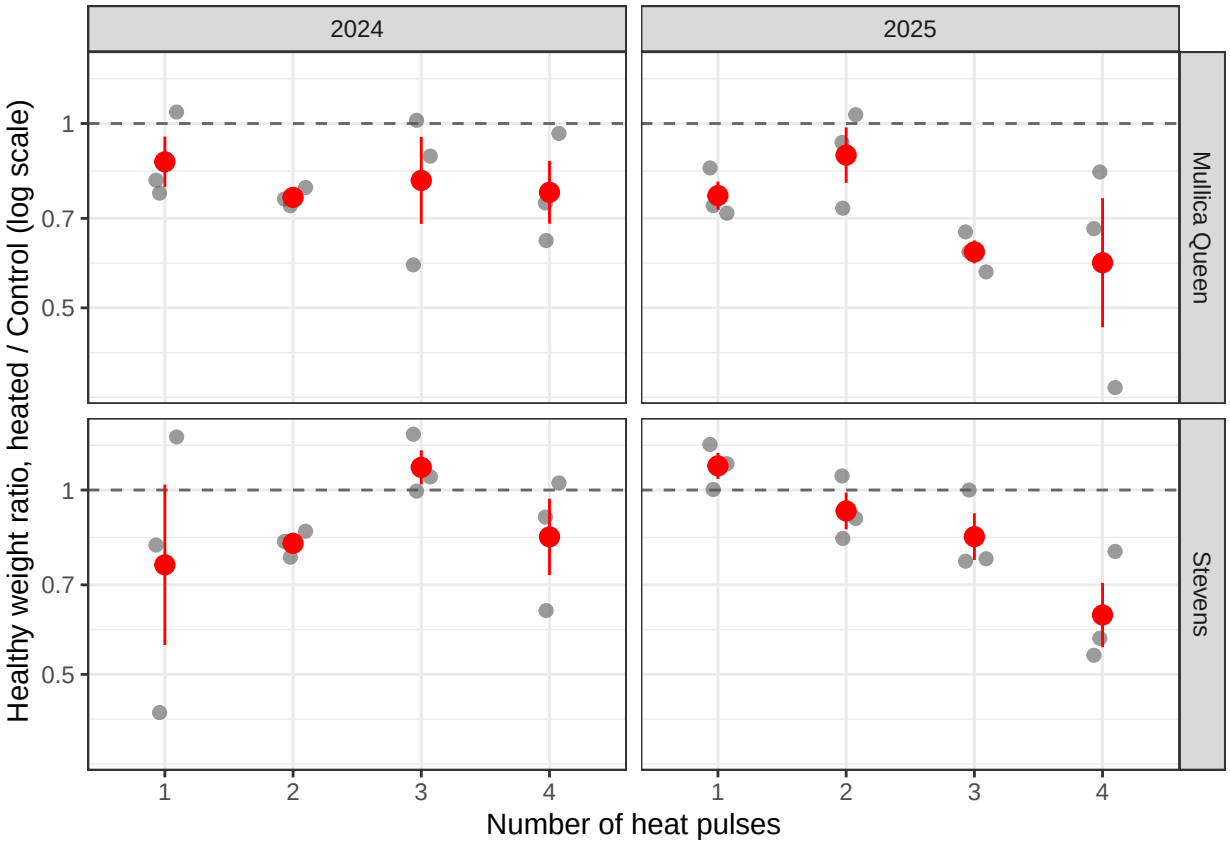


Figure 3: Ratio of healthy fruit weight in each heated (OTC) plot to that in its paired Control plot, by number of heat pulses, cultivar (rows) and year (columns). Grey points are the 48 individual pairs; red points and bars show the mean and plus or minus one standard error of the log ratios. The dashed line marks a ratio of 1 (no difference); points below it are pairs in which the heated plot produced less healthy fruit than its own Control. The vertical axis is on a logarithmic scale.

4.2 Methods

We modelled the natural logarithm of healthy fruit weight with a linear mixed model. The fixed effects were heat group (Control or 1, 2, 3 or 4 pulses), year, cultivar, the interaction between heat group and year, and the interaction between year and cultivar. The model also included a random effect for each pair of plots and, because heated plots varied more than Control plots, a separate residual variance for heated and Control plots. It was fitted by restricted maximum likelihood with the nlme package in R. On the log scale, each heat effect is a proportional change, so we report it as the ratio of healthy weight in heated plots to that in Control plots, or as the corresponding percentage reduction. Within each year, we compared the average of the four heat groups with Control, compared each heat group with Control, adjusting for multiple comparisons with Dunnett's method, and summarised the effect of intensity as the average change per additional pulse among heated plots. We chose this model by comparing it with simpler and more complex alternatives: allowing the heat effect to differ between years improved the fit, whereas allowing it to differ between cultivars did not. Details of the model, its selection and its checks are given in Appendix B.

4.3 Results

Overall effect of heat. Averaged over the four heat groups, both cultivars and both years, heated plots produced 20% less healthy fruit than Control plots (95% CI 14% to 25%, $p < 0.001$). The average reduction was similar in the two years, 17% in 2024 and 22% in 2025 ([Table: results]).

Table 3: Estimated effect of heat on healthy fruit weight in each year, averaged over the two cultivars. Each estimate is the ratio of healthy weight in heated plots to that in Control plots; a ratio of 0.80 means 20% less healthy fruit. For the individual heat groups, confidence intervals and p-values are adjusted for comparing four heat groups with the same Control using Dunnett's method. The last row is the multiplicative change in healthy weight for each additional heat pulse among heated plots, estimated as a straight-line trend across 1 to 4 pulses.

Comparison	2024: ratio (95% CI)	2024: p-value	2025: ratio (95% CI)	2025: p-value
Average of the four heat groups vs Control	0.83 (0.76 to 0.92)	< 0.001	0.78 (0.71 to 0.85)	< 0.001
1 pulse vs Control	0.84 (0.66 to 1.06)	0.176	0.89 (0.71 to 1.12)	0.505
2 pulses vs Control	0.80 (0.64 to 1.01)	0.065	0.93 (0.74 to 1.17)	0.785
3 pulses vs Control	0.90 (0.71 to 1.13)	0.565	0.73 (0.58 to 0.93)	0.006
4 pulses vs Control	0.80 (0.63 to 1.00)	0.056	0.60 (0.47 to 0.75)	< 0.001
Each additional pulse (from 1 to 4 pulses)	1.00 (0.92 to 1.08)	0.930	0.87 (0.80 to 0.94)	< 0.001

Individual heat groups and dose response. In 2025, the reduction grew with the number of pulses: plots that received three and four pulses produced 27% and 40% less healthy fruit than Control, and each additional pulse reduced healthy weight by about 13% (95% CI 6% to 20%). The estimated reductions for one and two pulses were smaller (11% and 7%), and their confidence intervals range from a reduction of about 29% to an increase of about 17%. In 2024, every heat group was estimated to produce 10% to 20% less healthy fruit than Control, with no trend with the number of pulses. None of these differences was

statistically discernible on its own, but their confidence intervals range from reductions of up to about 37% to increases of up to about 13%, so reductions of 20% or more remain plausible at every intensity. The two years therefore differ mainly in how the effect depends on the number of pulses, rather than in its average size.

Cultivars. There was no evidence that the proportional effect of heat differed between Mullica Queen and Stevens, but because their baselines differ, the same proportional reduction means very different losses in grams ([Figure: estimates]). In 2025, for example, four pulses reduced the estimated healthy weight of Mullica Queen from 1037 g to 621 g, but that of Stevens only from 377 g to 225 g.

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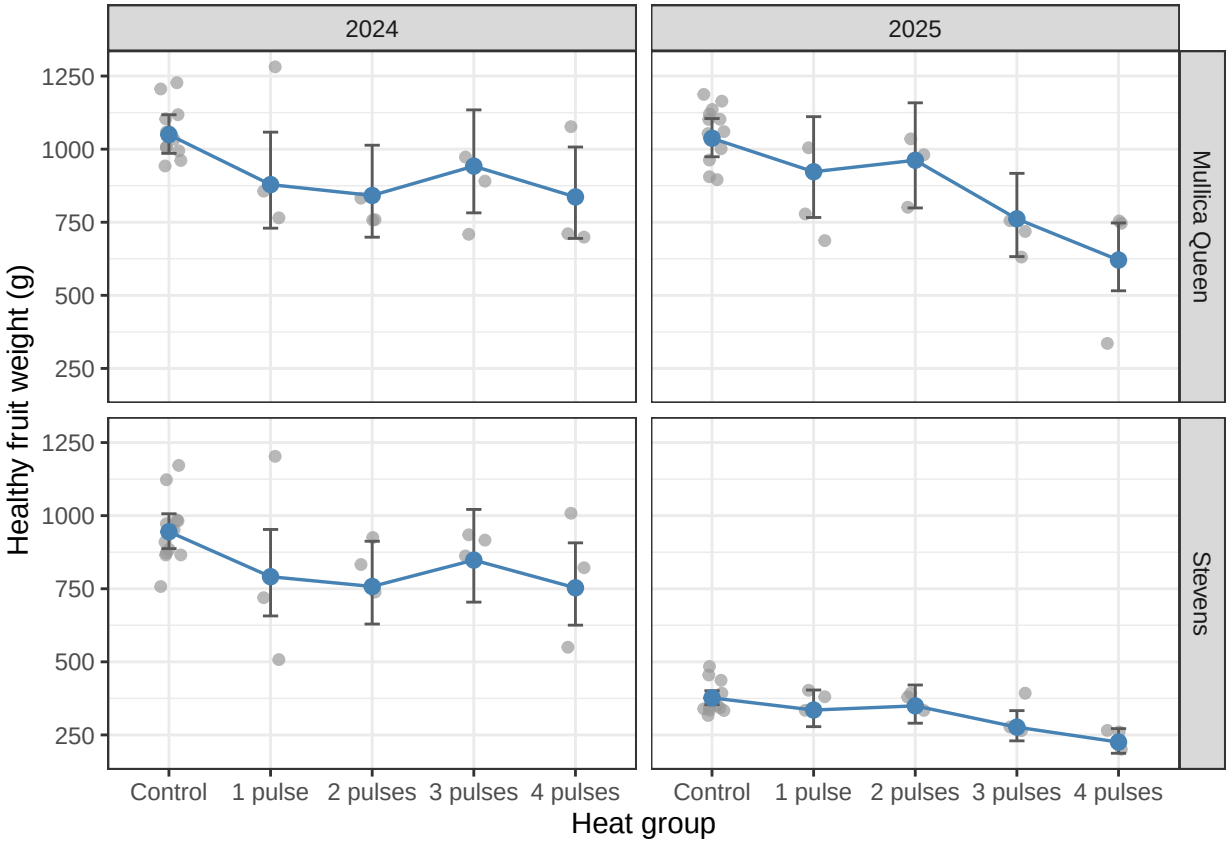


Figure 4: Estimated healthy fruit weight by heat group, cultivar (rows) and year (columns). Blue points are the means estimated by the final model, joined by lines, with 95% confidence intervals shown as bars; grey points are the individual plots. The model assumes that heat reduces healthy weight by the same proportion in both cultivars, so the estimated curves of the two cultivars have the same shape on a proportional scale.

Sensitivity to extreme plots. Removing the two heated plots with unusually low healthy weight made the estimated effects slightly smaller but did not change these conclusions; the only difference was that two heat groups in 2024 became individually statistically discernible, which confirms that the evidence for individual heat groups in 2024 is borderline (Appendix A.5).

4.4 Limitations

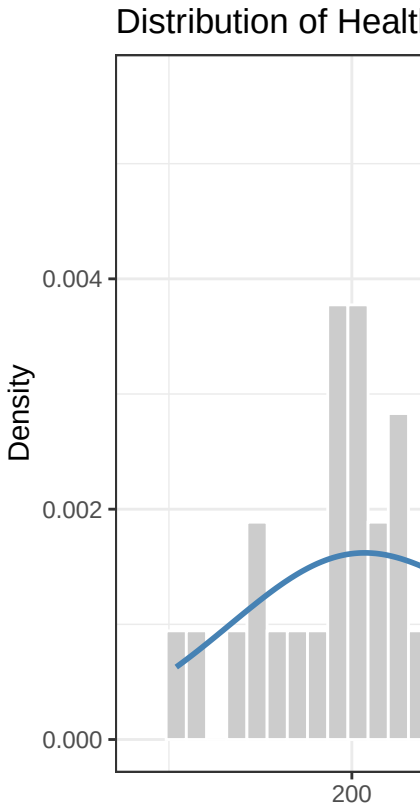
Only the heat treatment was assigned by the experimenters, so only its effects can be interpreted as causal; each cultivar was grown in a single field, so cultivar differences cannot be separated from field differences,

and year differences may reflect weather or other unmeasured conditions. With three pairs per heat group in each cultivar and year, the effects of individual heat groups are estimated imprecisely. The model was chosen after examining the data, so its p-values are likely to be somewhat optimistic. Finally, with only two years of data, we cannot tell whether the dose response seen in 2025 or its absence in 2024 is more typical.

4.5 Answer

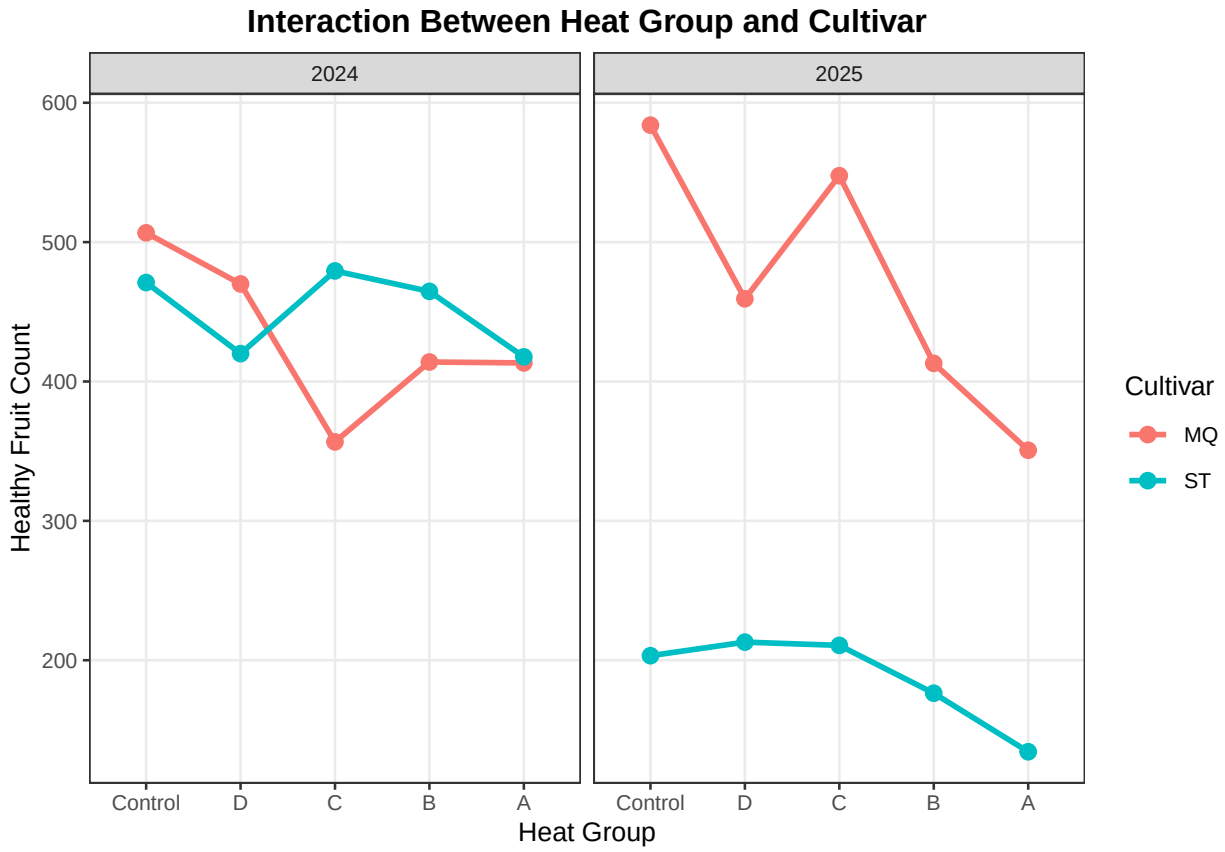
Heat stress reduced the total weight of healthy fruit by about 20% on average (95% CI 14% to 25%), with a similar average reduction in 2024 and 2025. The effect of the number of pulses, however, differed between years: in 2025 the reduction grew by about 13% with each additional pulse and reached about 40% with four pulses, whereas in 2024 the number of pulses made little difference. The proportional effect was similar for both cultivars, so losses in grams were larger for Mullica Queen, which has the higher baseline. Because this reduction is larger than that for total fruit weight (Section 3), heat appears to lower healthy weight partly by increasing the share of rotten fruit.

5) How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the percentage of healthy berries by count?



First, we investigate the distribution of the healthy berries by count (n_healthy) variable

Let's look at interaction plot



- Note (Soren) : effect of heat group differ by culttivar
- Slopes differ across groups showing a possible heat group x cultivar interaction
- Patterns differ across - a possible heat group x culticar x year interaction

Model Generation

```
##  Family: nbinom2  ( log )
## Formula:
## healthy_n ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) + (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##    1175.9    1199.0    -579.0    1157.9        87
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.06198  0.249
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for nbinom2 family (): 32.9
##
## Conditional model:
```

```
##                  Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)       6.45584    0.07261   88.91  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD      -0.12947    0.06965   -1.86   0.0630 .
## heat_groupC      -0.11745    0.06949   -1.69   0.0910 .
## heat_groupB      -0.14598    0.07013   -2.08   0.0374 *
## heat_groupA      -0.30171    0.07041   -4.28 1.83e-05 ***
## cultivarST       -0.48475    0.08104   -5.98 2.21e-09 ***
## factor(year)2025 -0.38285    0.08105   -4.72 2.31e-06 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##  Family: nbinom2  ( log )
## Formula:
## healthy_n ~ heat_group * cultivar * factor(year) + (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##    1109.3    1165.7    -532.6    1065.3        74
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.006145 0.07839
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for nbinom2 family (): 52.4
##
## Conditional model:
##                                        Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)                             6.22716    0.04765  130.69  < 2e-16
## heat_groupD                            -0.09040    0.10054   -0.90 0.368561
## heat_groupC                            -0.34390    0.10142   -3.39 0.000696
## heat_groupB                            -0.19746    0.10081   -1.96 0.050149
## heat_groupA                            -0.21340    0.10084   -2.12 0.034321
## cultivarST                             -0.07370    0.06751   -1.09 0.274944
## factor(year)2025                        0.14289    0.06722    2.13 0.033536
## heat_groupD:cultivarST                 -0.05899    0.14293   -0.41 0.679806
## heat_groupC:cultivarST                  0.33573    0.14394    2.33 0.019675
## heat_groupB:cultivarST                  0.21041    0.14331    1.47 0.142053
## heat_groupA:cultivarST                  0.11118    0.14420    0.77 0.440700
## heat_groupD:factor(year)2025           -0.15309    0.14180   -1.08 0.280319
## heat_groupC:factor(year)2025            0.27846    0.14220    1.96 0.050200
## heat_groupB:factor(year)2025           -0.16449    0.14283   -1.15 0.249459
## heat_groupA:factor(year)2025           -0.29541    0.14350   -2.06 0.039533
## cultivarST:factor(year)2025            -0.98768    0.09663  -10.22  < 2e-16
## heat_groupD:cultivarST:factor(year)2025  0.36382    0.20511    1.77 0.076103
## heat_groupC:cultivarST:factor(year)2025 -0.25160    0.20343   -1.24 0.216159
## heat_groupB:cultivarST:factor(year)2025  0.03539    0.20544    0.17 0.863220
## heat_groupA:cultivarST:factor(year)2025 -0.02577    0.20919   -0.12 0.901943
##
## (Intercept)                            ***
## heat_groupD
## heat_groupC                            ***
```

```
## heat_groupB                              .
## heat_groupA                              *
## cultivarST
## factor(year)2025                         *
## heat_groupD:cultivarST
## heat_groupC:cultivarST                   *
## heat_groupB:cultivarST
## heat_groupA:cultivarST
## heat_groupD:factor(year)2025
## heat_groupC:factor(year)2025             .
## heat_groupB:factor(year)2025
## heat_groupA:factor(year)2025             *
## cultivarST:factor(year)2025              ***
## heat_groupD:cultivarST:factor(year)2025 .
## heat_groupC:cultivarST:factor(year)2025
## heat_groupB:cultivarST:factor(year)2025
## heat_groupA:cultivarST:factor(year)2025
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

## Data: data
## Models:
## m1: healthy_n ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) + (1 | pair_id), zi=~0, disp=~1
## m2: healthy_n ~ heat_group * cultivar * factor(year) + (1 | pair_id), zi=~0, disp=~1
##    Df    AIC    BIC  logLik deviance  Chisq Chi Df Pr(>Chisq)
## m1  9 1175.9 1199.0 -578.95   1157.9
## m2 22 1109.3 1165.7 -532.65   1065.3 92.606     13  4.427e-14 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##  Family: nbinom2  ( log )
## Formula:
## healthy_n ~ (heat_group + cultivar + factor(year))^2 + (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##    1106.5    1152.7    -535.3    1070.5        78
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.005143 0.07171
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for nbinom2 family (): 46.7
##
## Conditional model:
##                             Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)                  6.23071    0.04637  134.38  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD                 -0.17254    0.09086   -1.90  0.05757 .
## heat_groupC                 -0.28024    0.09230   -3.04  0.00239 **
## heat_groupB                 -0.20554    0.09113   -2.26  0.02411 *
## heat_groupA                 -0.20767    0.09155   -2.27  0.02330 *
```

```
## cultivarST                    -0.08041    0.06192   -1.30  0.19407
## factor(year)2025               0.13601    0.06174    2.20  0.02761 *
## heat_groupD:cultivarST         0.11981    0.10590    1.13  0.25791
## heat_groupC:cultivarST         0.21631    0.10692    2.02  0.04306 *
## heat_groupB:cultivarST         0.22081    0.10874    2.03  0.04228 *
## heat_groupA:cultivarST         0.09737    0.10740    0.91  0.36458
## heat_groupD:factor(year)2025   0.01824    0.10755    0.17  0.86536
## heat_groupC:factor(year)2025   0.15492    0.10561    1.47  0.14241
## heat_groupB:factor(year)2025 -0.14583    0.10646   -1.37  0.17072
## heat_groupA:factor(year)2025 -0.30638    0.10744   -2.85  0.00435 **
## cultivarST:factor(year)2025  -0.97237    0.07605  -12.79  < 2e-16 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

```
## Data: data
## Models:
## m_add: healthy_n ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) + (1 | pair_id), zi=~0, disp=~1
## m_2way: healthy_n ~ (heat_group + cultivar + factor(year))^2 + (1 | pair_id), zi=~0, disp=~1
## m_3way: healthy_n ~ heat_group * cultivar * factor(year) + (1 | pair_id), zi=~0, disp=~1
##        Df    AIC    BIC  logLik deviance   Chisq Chi Df Pr(>Chisq)
## m_add   9 1175.9 1199.0 -578.95   1157.9
## m_2way 18 1106.5 1152.7 -535.27   1070.5 87.3562      9  5.514e-15 ***
## m_3way 22 1109.3 1165.7 -532.65   1065.3  5.2497      4     0.2626
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

From the first anova, we show that there is strong evidence that the association between heat group and healthy fruit count depends on cultivar, year or their combination. But when we add a 2 way interaction model, we see that 2 way interaction model does way better.

– One important detail: because nbinom2 uses a log link, the coefficients are on the log expected-count scale. Exponentiating a coefficient gives a count ratio.

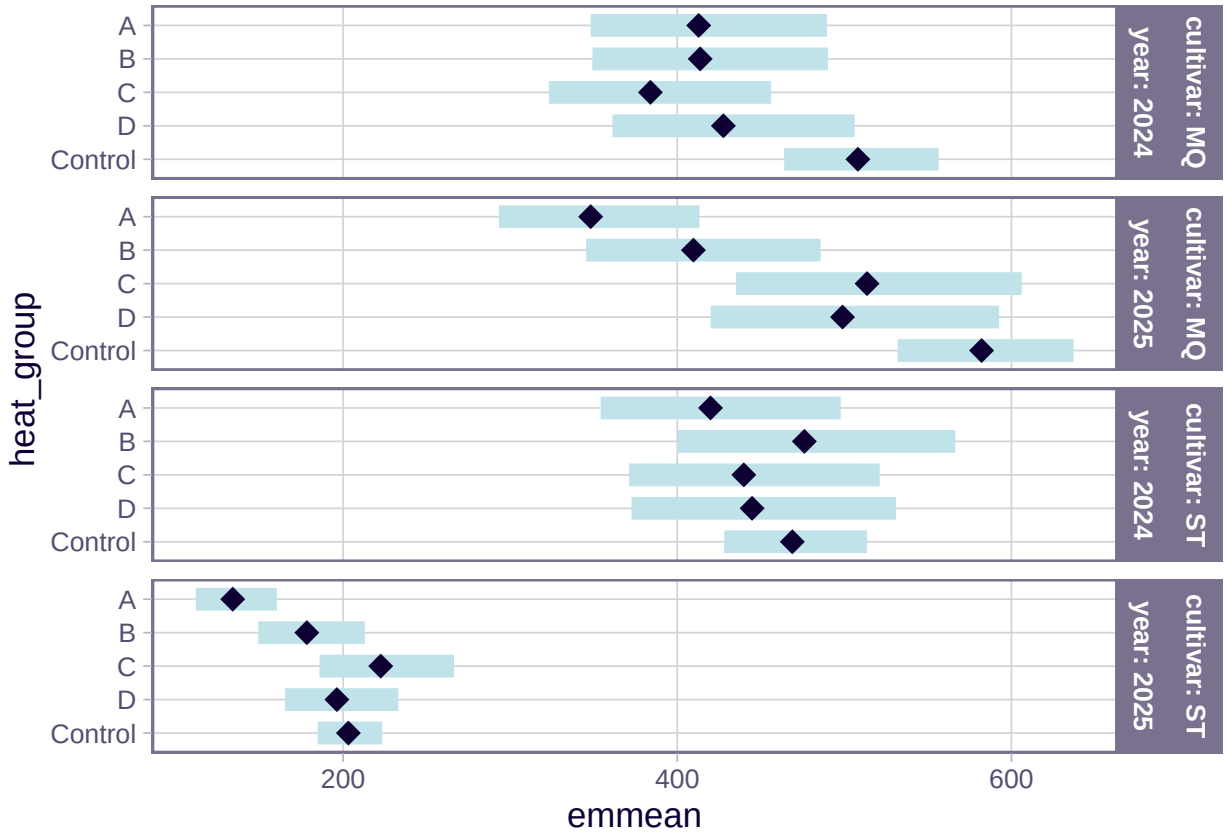
heat_groupD, pvalue (0.0576), About 15.8% fewer healthy fruits than Control; borderline evidence

percentages are calculated as (exp(beta) - 1) * 100

What the model concludes : Healthy fruit counts differ across several heat groups relative to Control. The heat-group effects for C and B differ between cultivars. The A-versus-Control effect differs between years. The cultivar difference changes substantially between years.

There is no statistically significant evidence that the full three-way interaction improves model fit ($p = 0.263$, from your earlier comparison).

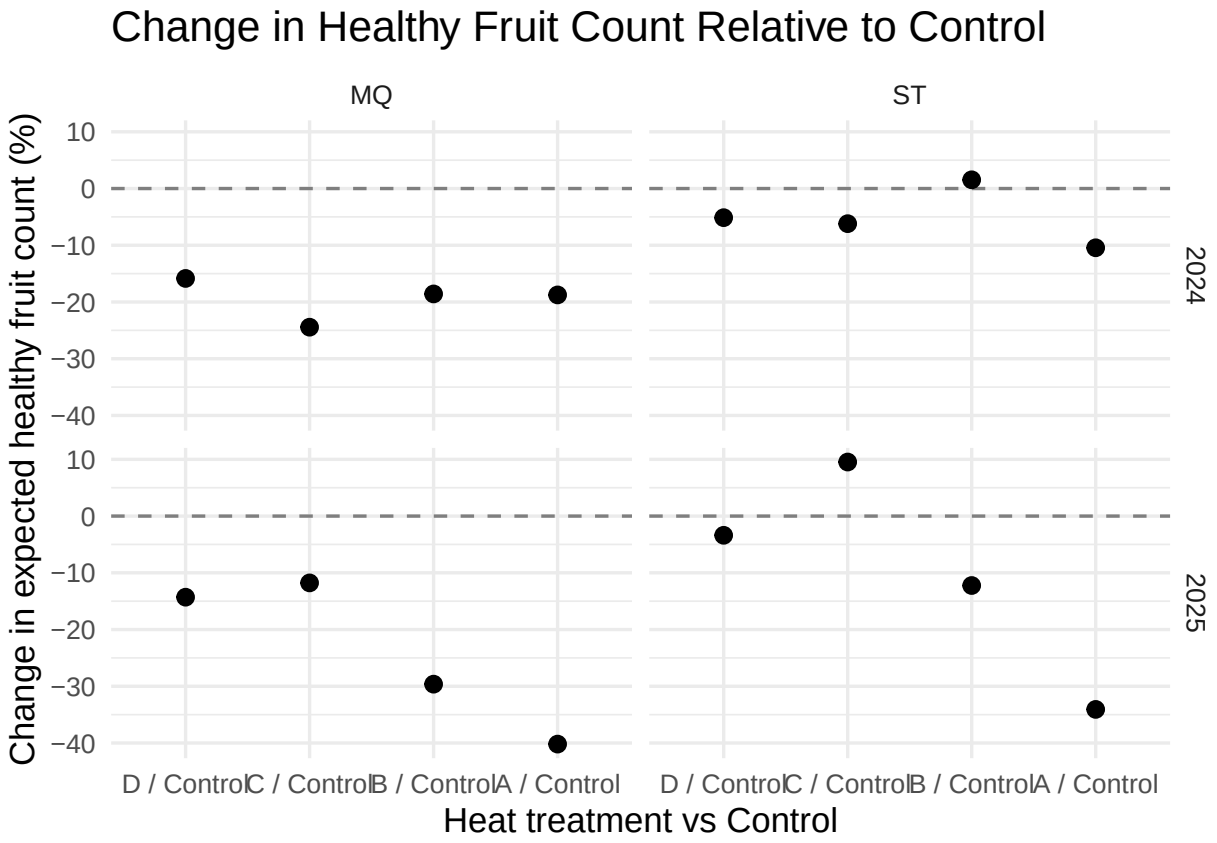
TODO : look into this one more




```
## cultivar = MQ, year = 2024:
##  contrast    ratio     SE  df null z.ratio p.value
##  D / Control 0.842 0.0765 Inf    1  -1.899  0.1817
##  C / Control 0.756 0.0697 Inf    1  -3.036  0.0090
##  B / Control 0.814 0.0742 Inf    1  -2.255  0.0824
##  A / Control 0.812 0.0744 Inf    1  -2.268  0.0798
##
## cultivar = ST, year = 2024:
##  contrast    ratio     SE  df null z.ratio p.value
##  D / Control 0.949 0.0893 Inf    1  -0.560  0.9105
##  C / Control 0.938 0.0852 Inf    1  -0.704  0.8497
##  B / Control 1.015 0.0952 Inf    1   0.163  0.9952
##  A / Control 0.896 0.0823 Inf    1  -1.201  0.5547
##
## cultivar = MQ, year = 2025:
##  contrast    ratio     SE  df null z.ratio p.value
##  D / Control 0.857 0.0789 Inf    1  -1.676  0.2768
##  C / Control 0.882 0.0788 Inf    1  -1.403  0.4272
##  B / Control 0.704 0.0642 Inf    1  -3.850  0.0005
##  A / Control 0.598 0.0551 Inf    1  -5.582 <0.0001
##
## cultivar = ST, year = 2025:
##  contrast    ratio     SE  df null z.ratio p.value
```

```
##  D / Control 0.966 0.0896 Inf    1  -0.372  0.9658
##  C / Control 1.095 0.1050 Inf    1   0.951  0.7139
##  B / Control 0.878 0.0843 Inf    1  -1.359  0.4538
##  A / Control 0.659 0.0635 Inf    1  -4.323 <0.0001
##
## P value adjustment: dunnettx method for 4 tests
## Tests are performed on the log scale
```

```
## [1] "contrast" "cultivar" "year"     "ratio"    "SE"       "df"       "null"
## [8] "z.ratio"  "p.value"
```



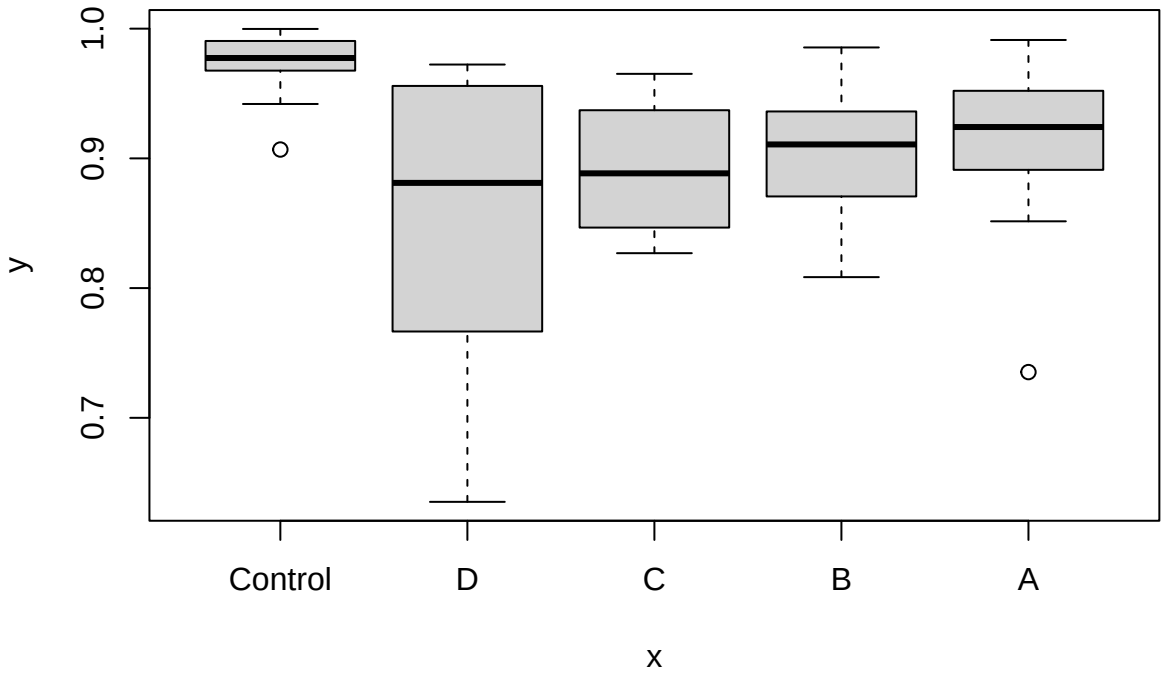
How big is the difference between the controls and the heat treatments ? - contrast above shows it and there is a plot too (TODO : look into the plot more)

Table 4: Model Odds Ratios and 95% Confidence Intervals

	Term	Odds Ratio	95% CI Lower	95% CI Upper	p-value
(Intercept)	(Intercept)	636.41	551.99	733.74	< 0.001
heat_groupD	heat_groupD	0.88	0.77	1.01	0.063
heat_groupC	heat_groupC	0.89	0.78	1.02	0.091
heat_groupB	heat_groupB	0.86	0.75	0.99	0.037
heat_groupA	heat_groupA	0.74	0.64	0.85	< 0.001
cultivarST	cultivarST	0.62	0.53	0.72	< 0.001
factor(year)2025	factor(year)2025	0.68	0.58	0.80	< 0.001

6) How does heat stress affect yield as measured by the percentage of healthy fruit by weight?

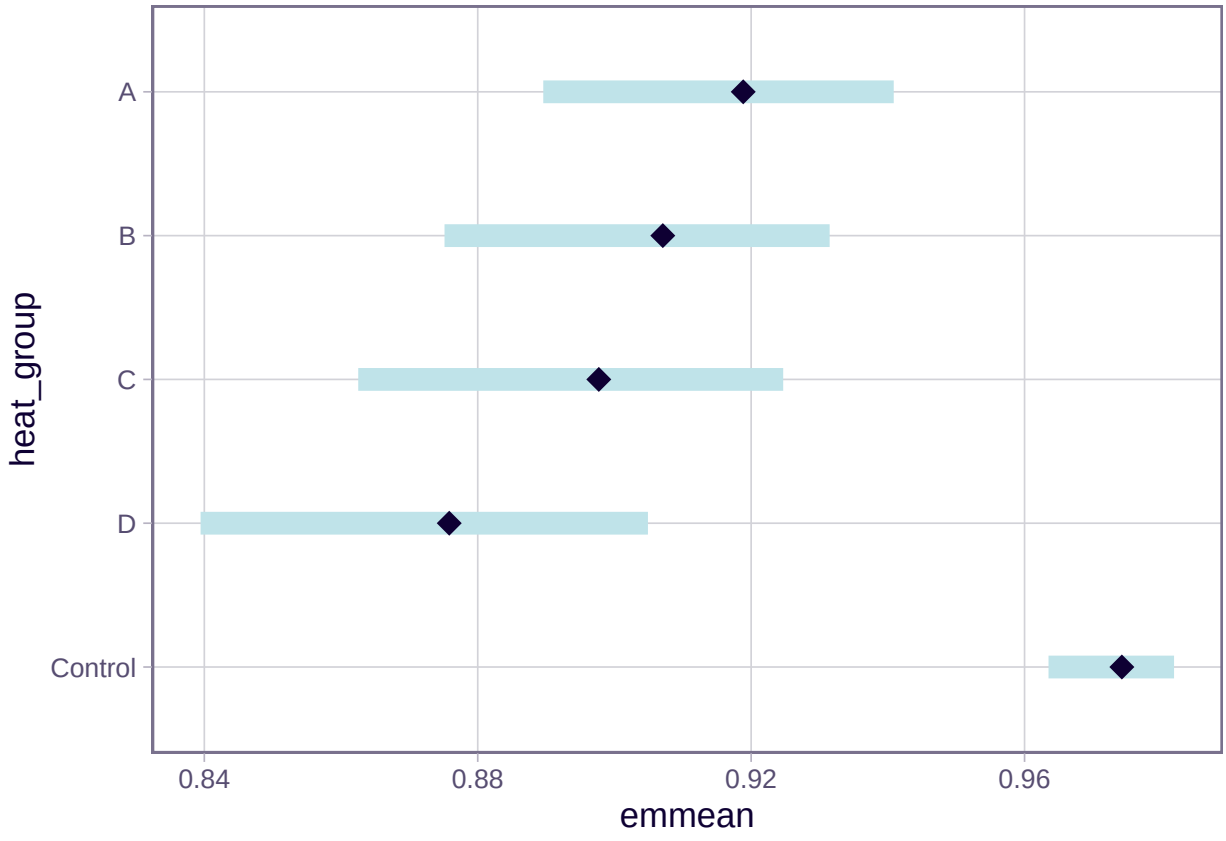
binomial model underpredict heritabiltiy




```
##  Family: beta  ( logit )
## Formula:          healthy_weight_prop ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) +
##     (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##    -392.9    -369.8     205.4    -410.9        87
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.06685  0.2586
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for beta family (): 41.8
##
## Conditional model:
##                  Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)       3.32263    0.20713  16.041  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD      -1.67928    0.24953  -6.730 1.70e-11 ***
```

```
## heat_groupC      -1.46072    0.20468  -7.137 9.56e-13 ***
## heat_groupB      -1.35435    0.21442  -6.316 2.68e-10 ***
## heat_groupA      -1.20608    0.25170  -4.792 1.65e-06 ***
## cultivarST        0.60925    0.14287   4.264 2.01e-05 ***
## factor(year)2025  0.01113    0.14115   0.079    0.937
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

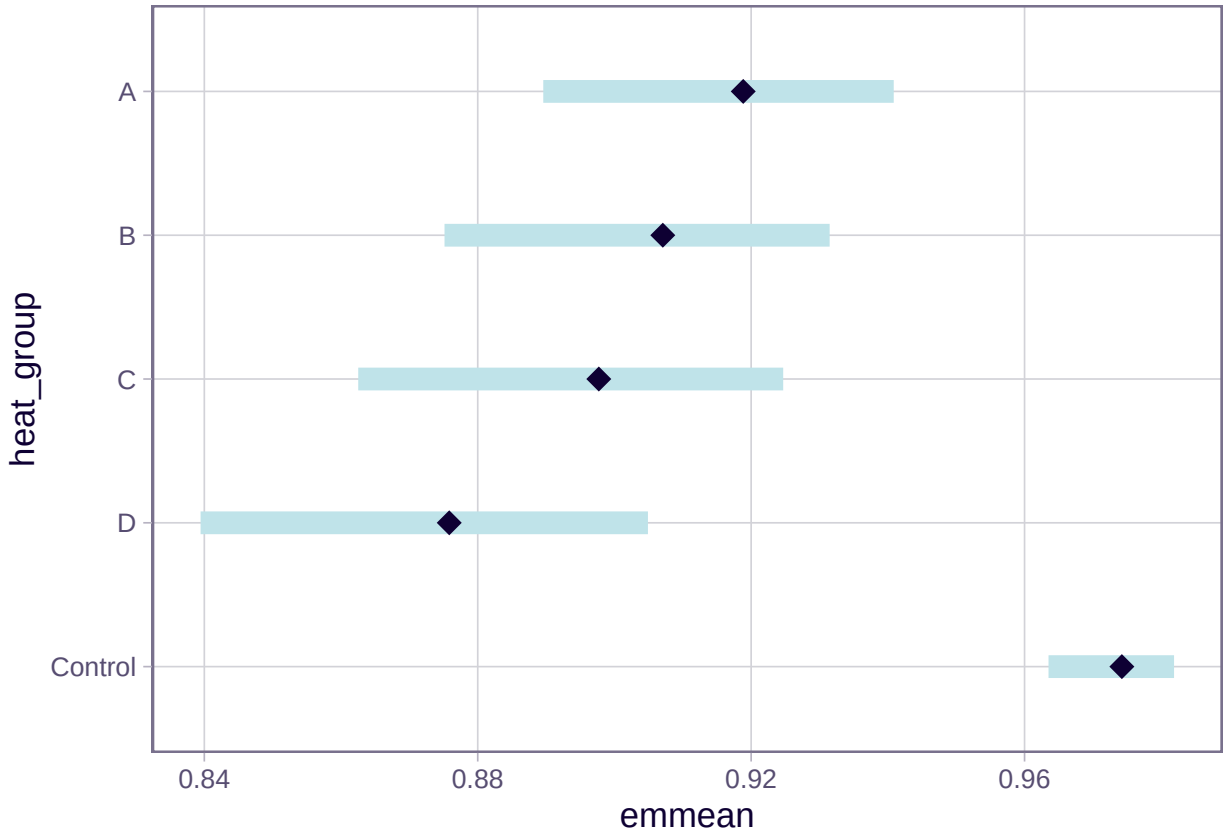
```
##  heat_group response     SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control       0.974 0.0046 Inf     0.964     0.982
##  D             0.876 0.0166 Inf     0.839     0.905
##  C             0.898 0.0157 Inf     0.863     0.925
##  B             0.907 0.0142 Inf     0.875     0.931
##  A             0.919 0.0129 Inf     0.890     0.941
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: cultivar, year
## Confidence level used: 0.95
## Intervals are back-transformed from the logit scale
```




```
##                         Term Odds_Ratio   CI_Lower   CI_Upper      p_value
## (Intercept)      (Intercept) 27.7331821 18.4792710 41.6211976 6.600558e-58
## heat_groupD      heat_groupD  0.1865089  0.1143660  0.3041600 1.698841e-11
## heat_groupC      heat_groupC  0.2320683  0.1553789  0.3466089 9.555779e-13
## heat_groupB      heat_groupB  0.2581160  0.1695493  0.3929468 2.679090e-10
## heat_groupA      heat_groupA  0.2993679  0.1827910  0.4902930 1.653208e-06
```

```
## cultivarST             cultivarST  1.8390479  1.3898800  2.4333736 2.005567e-05
## factor(year)2025 factor(year)2025  1.0111895  0.7668041  1.3334620 9.371646e-01
```

```
##  heat_group response     SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control       0.974 0.0046 Inf     0.964     0.982
##  D             0.876 0.0166 Inf     0.839     0.905
##  C             0.898 0.0157 Inf     0.863     0.925
##  B             0.907 0.0142 Inf     0.875     0.931
##  A             0.919 0.0129 Inf     0.890     0.941
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: cultivar, year
## Confidence level used: 0.95
## Intervals are back-transformed from the logit scale
```

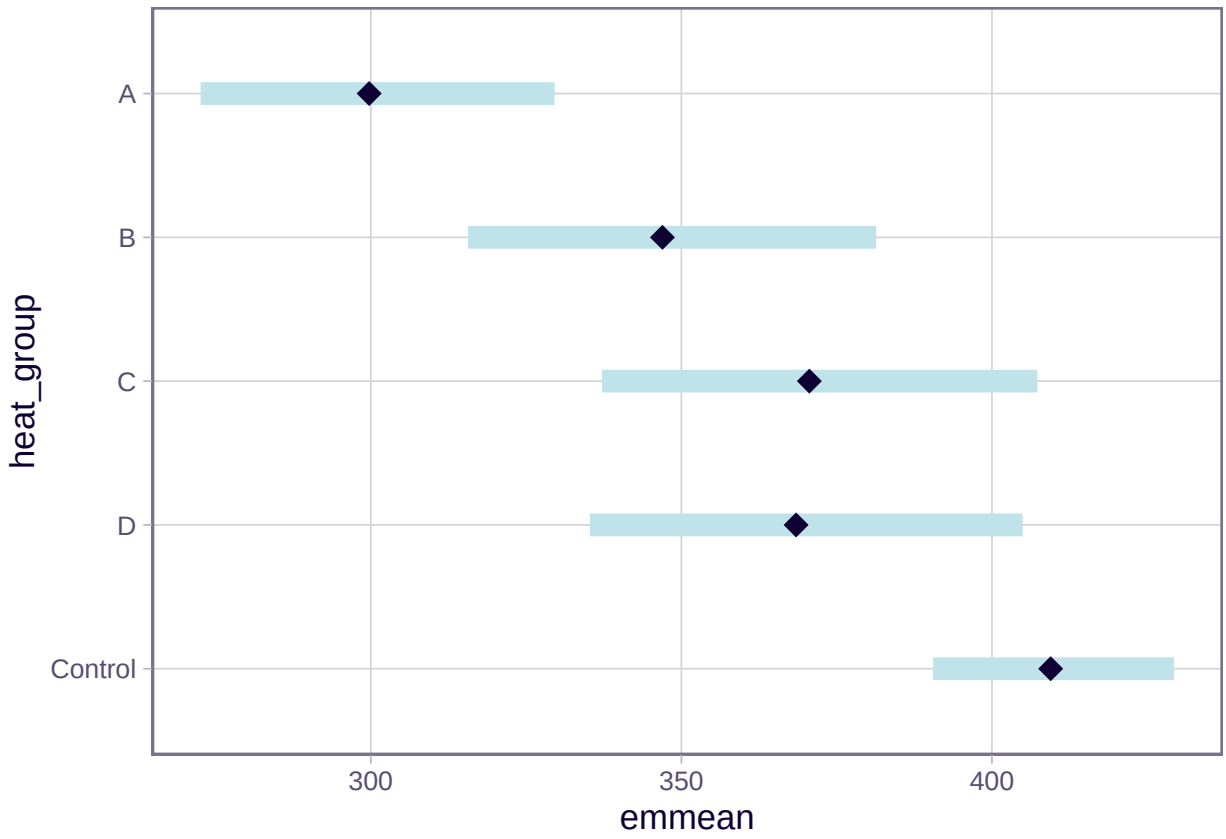



```
##  contrast    odds.ratio    SE  df null z.ratio p.value
##  Control / D      5.362 1.340 Inf    1   6.730 <0.0001
##  Control / C      4.309 0.882 Inf    1   7.137 <0.0001
##  Control / B      3.874 0.831 Inf    1   6.316 <0.0001
##  Control / A      3.340 0.841 Inf    1   4.792 <0.0001
##  D / C            0.804 0.191 Inf    1  -0.920  0.8893
##  D / B            0.723 0.168 Inf    1  -1.394  0.6317
##  D / A            0.623 0.141 Inf    1  -2.086  0.2260
##  C / B            0.899 0.203 Inf    1  -0.471  0.9899
##  C / A            0.775 0.191 Inf    1  -1.034  0.8399
##  B / A            0.862 0.210 Inf    1  -0.609  0.9737
```

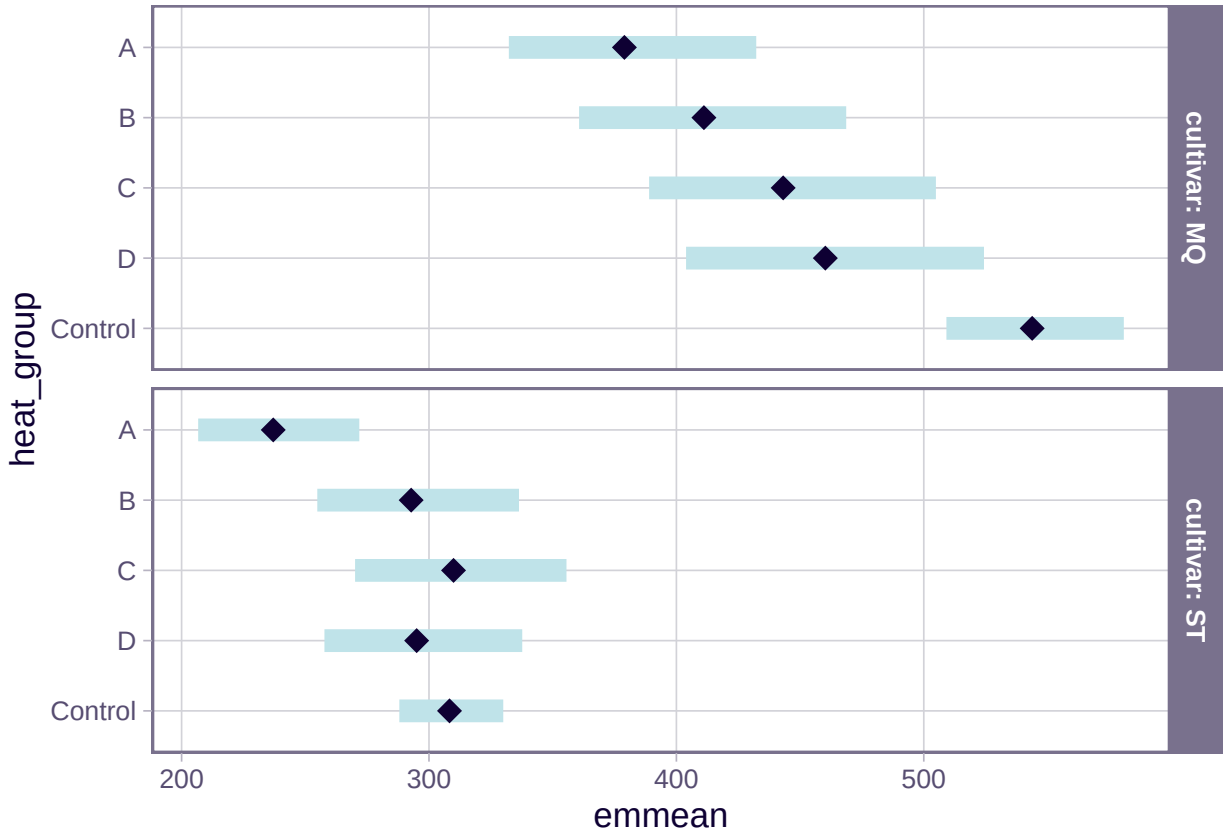
```
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: cultivar, year
## P value adjustment: tukey method for comparing a family of 5 estimates
## Tests are performed on the log odds ratio scale
```

```
##  Family: beta  ( logit )
## Formula:
## healthy_weight_prop_adj ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) +
##     (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##    -392.9    -369.8     205.4    -410.9        87
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.06685  0.2586
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for beta family (): 41.8
##
## Conditional model:
##                  Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)       3.32263    0.20713  16.041  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD      -1.67928    0.24953  -6.730 1.70e-11 ***
## heat_groupC      -1.46072    0.20468  -7.137 9.56e-13 ***
## heat_groupB      -1.35435    0.21442  -6.316 2.68e-10 ***
## heat_groupA      -1.20608    0.25170  -4.792 1.65e-06 ***
## cultivarST        0.60925    0.14287   4.264 2.01e-05 ***
## factor(year)2025  0.01113    0.14115   0.079    0.937
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

```
##  heat_group response   SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control         409  9.9 Inf       391       429
##  D               368 17.7 Inf       335       405
##  C               371 17.9 Inf       337       407
##  B               347 16.7 Inf       316       381
##  A               300 14.5 Inf       273       330
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: cultivar, year
## Confidence level used: 0.95
## Intervals are back-transformed from the log scale
```




```
## cultivar = MQ:
##  heat_group response   SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control         544 18.3 Inf       509       581
##  D               460 30.6 Inf       404       524
##  C               443 29.5 Inf       389       505
##  B               411 27.5 Inf       361       469
##  A               379 25.4 Inf       332       432
##
## cultivar = ST:
##  heat_group response   SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control         308 10.7 Inf       288       330
##  D               295 20.3 Inf       258       338
##  C               310 21.7 Inf       270       356
##  B               293 20.7 Inf       255       336
##  A               237 16.6 Inf       207       272
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: year
## Confidence level used: 0.95
## Intervals are back-transformed from the log scale
```

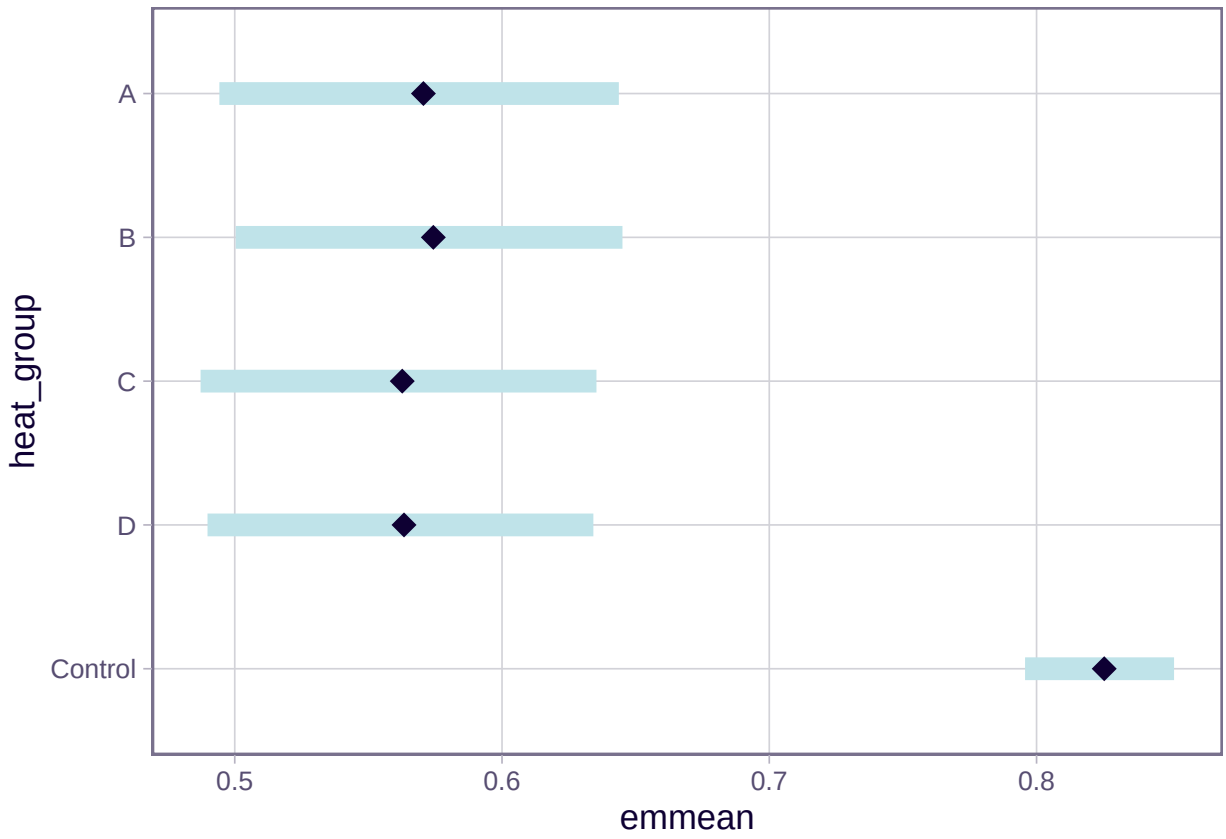



```
##  Family: betabinomial  ( logit )
## Formula:
## cbind(healthy_n, rotten_n) ~ heat_group + cultivar + factor(year) +
##     (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##     858.1     881.2    -420.1     840.1        87
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.06791  0.2606
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for betabinomial family (): 44.3
##
## Conditional model:
##                  Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)        3.0034     0.1570  19.126  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD       -1.2895     0.1919  -6.720 1.81e-11 ***
## heat_groupC       -1.2591     0.1708  -7.369 1.71e-13 ***
## heat_groupB       -1.2888     0.1700  -7.580 3.45e-14 ***
## heat_groupA       -1.4349     0.1874  -7.658 1.89e-14 ***
## cultivarST         0.1702     0.1272   1.338   0.1809
```

```
## factor(year)2025  -0.2635     0.1273  -2.070   0.0385 *
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

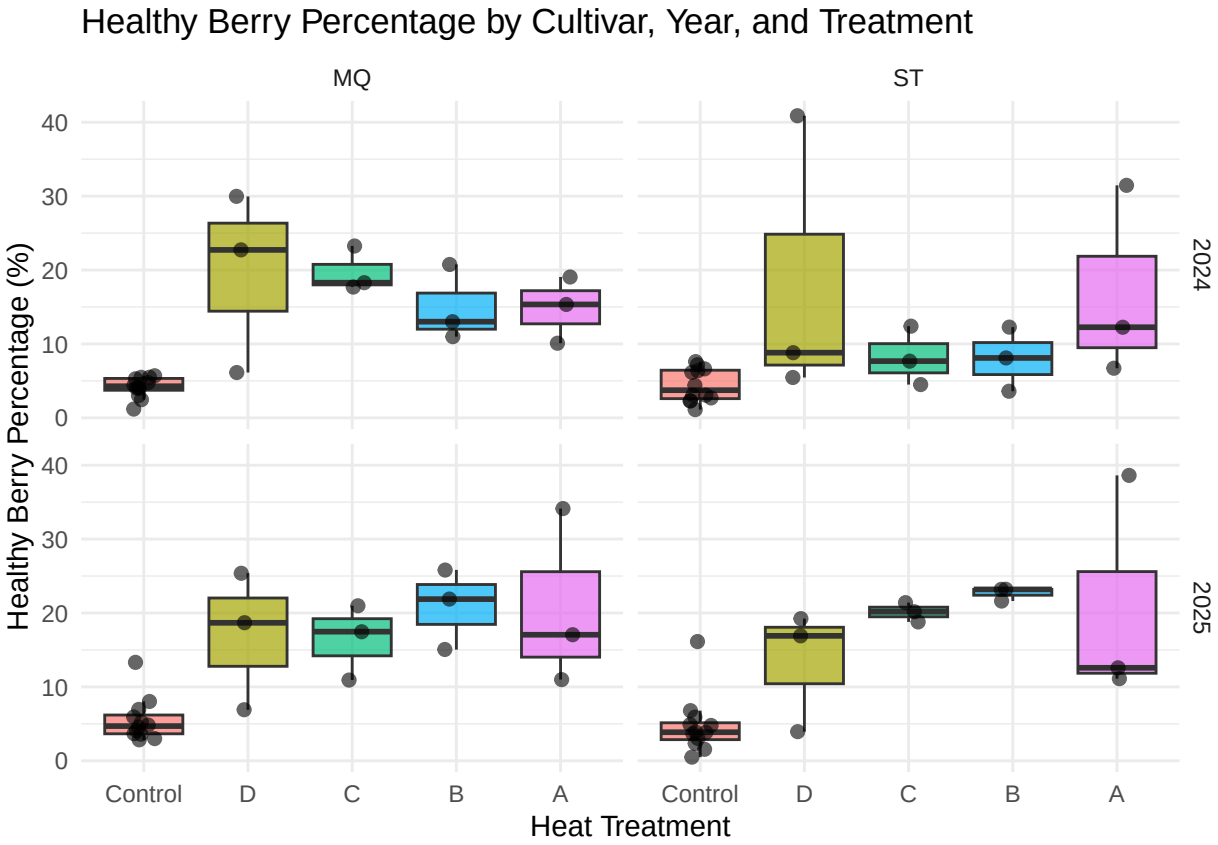
```
##  Family: betabinomial  ( logit )
## Formula:
## cbind(healthy_count_pct, (data$healthy_n + data$rotten_n) - healthy_n) ~
##     heat_group + cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## Data: data
##
##       AIC       BIC    logLik -2*log(L)  df.resid
##     794.4     814.9    -389.2     778.4        88
##
## Random effects:
##
## Conditional model:
##  Groups  Name        Variance Std.Dev.
##  pair_id (Intercept) 0.04434  0.2106
## Number of obs: 96, groups:  pair_id, 48
##
## Dispersion parameter for betabinomial family (): 19.2
##
## Conditional model:
##             Estimate Std. Error z value Pr(>|z|)
## (Intercept)   1.2425     0.1116  11.137  < 2e-16 ***
## heat_groupD  -1.2982     0.1768  -7.344 2.07e-13 ***
## heat_groupC  -1.3009     0.1736  -7.494 6.68e-14 ***
## heat_groupB  -1.2534     0.1739  -7.208 5.66e-13 ***
## heat_groupA  -1.2686     0.1842  -6.888 5.65e-12 ***
## cultivarST    0.6207     0.1262   4.919 8.70e-07 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

```
##  heat_group response     SE  df asymp.LCL asymp.UCL
##  Control       0.825 0.0142 Inf     0.796     0.851
##  D             0.563 0.0371 Inf     0.490     0.634
##  C             0.563 0.0381 Inf     0.487     0.635
##  B             0.574 0.0372 Inf     0.500     0.645
##  A             0.571 0.0384 Inf     0.494     0.644
##
## Results are averaged over the levels of: cultivar
## Unknown transformation "(": no transformation done
## Confidence level used: 0.95
```



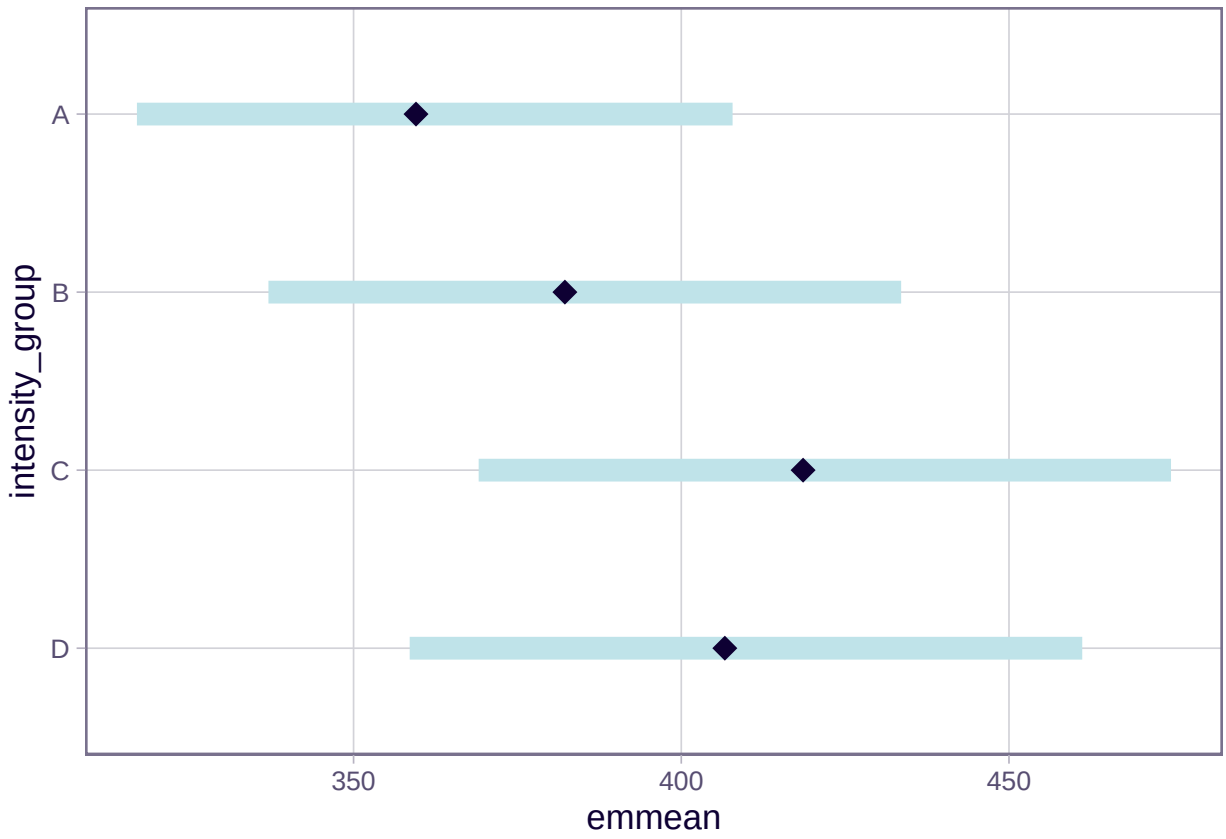

```
## , , heat_group = Control
##
##       cultivar
## year   MQ ST
##   2024 12 12
##   2025 12 12
##
## , , heat_group = D
##
##       cultivar
## year   MQ ST
##   2024  3  3
##   2025  3  3
##
## , , heat_group = C
##
##       cultivar
## year   MQ ST
##   2024  3  3
##   2025  3  3
##
## , , heat_group = B
##
##       cultivar
## year   MQ ST
##   2024  3  3
```

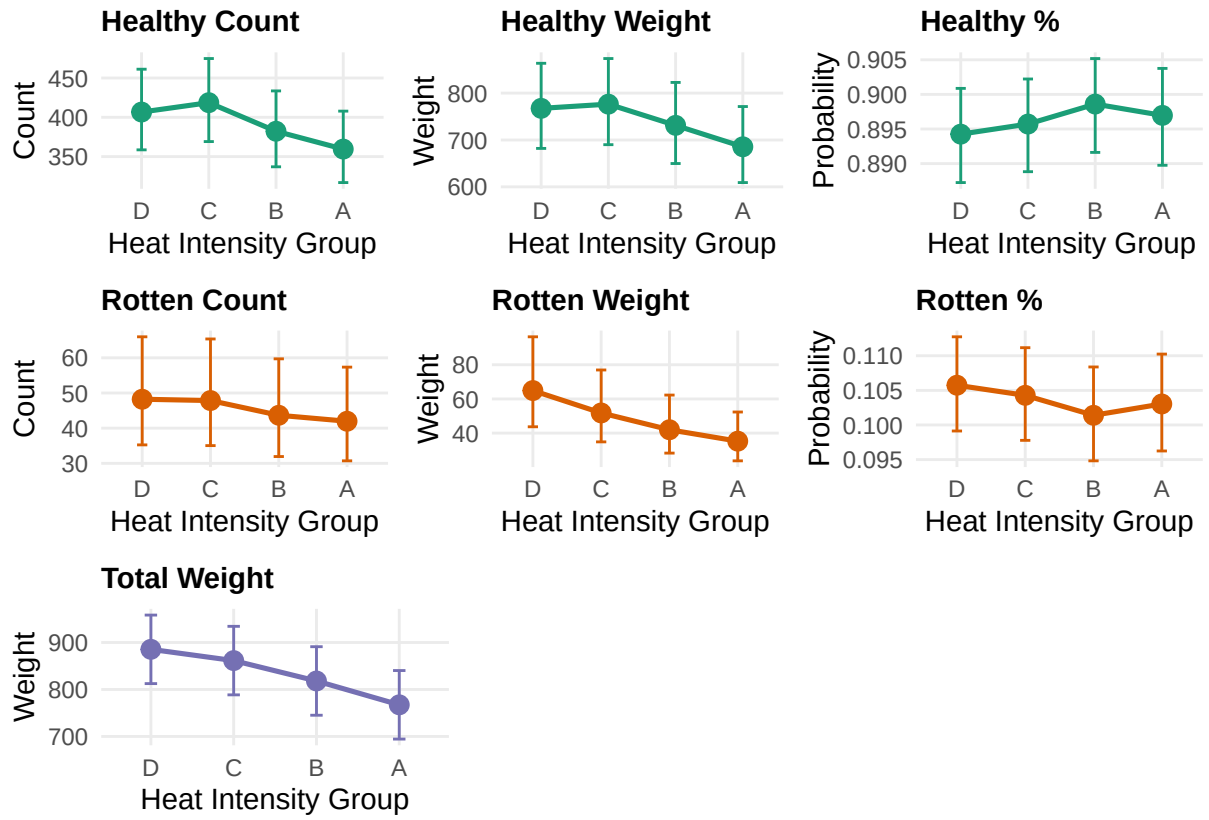
```
##   2025  3  3
##
## , , heat_group = A
##
##       cultivar
## year   MQ ST
##   2024  3  3
##   2025  3  3
```



5. How do the cultivars, years, and intensity of the heat shocks (in the case of the acute heat stress experiment) affect the various measures of yield?

Identified measures of yield - rotten_n - rotten_weight - healthy_n - healthy_weight - total_weight - healthy_countr_percentage - rotten_count_percentage


intensity_group
A
B
C
D
350
400
450
emmean



7) Conclusion

8) Reference

9) Appendix

Appendix A: Total weight of fruit (Section 3)

A.1 Model specification The final model for plot i is

$$\log(Y_i) = \mu + \alpha_{g(i)} + \beta_{t(i)} + (\alpha\beta)_{g(i)\,t(i)} + \gamma_{c(i)} + (\beta\gamma)_{t(i)\,c(i)} + b_{k(i)} + \varepsilon_i,$$

where Y_i is the total fruit weight in grams and log is the natural logarithm. μ is the overall intercept, α_g the effect of heat group g, β_t the effect of year t, γ_c the effect of cultivar c, $(\alpha\beta)_{gt}$ the heat-by-year interaction, and $(\beta\gamma)_{tc}$ the cultivar-by-year shift. b_k is the random intercept of pair k, with $b_k \sim N(0, \sigma_b^2)$, and ε_i is the residual error, with variance $\sigma^2_{\text{Control}}$ in Control plots and σ^2_{Heated} in heated plots. The estimated standard deviations are $\hat{\sigma}_b = 0.067$, $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Control}} = 0.09$ and $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Heated}} = 0.164$. The model was fitted by restricted maximum likelihood in R with nlme. The estimated coefficients are in Section 3.2.

A.2 Choice of response scale and model **Response scale.** Total weight is strictly positive and right-skewed, so the response is logged.

Across the 20 cells defined by cultivar, year and heat group, the Spearman correlation between the group mean and the group standard deviation is 0.49 on the raw scale and -0.15 on the log scale, so the log scale gives the more even spread.

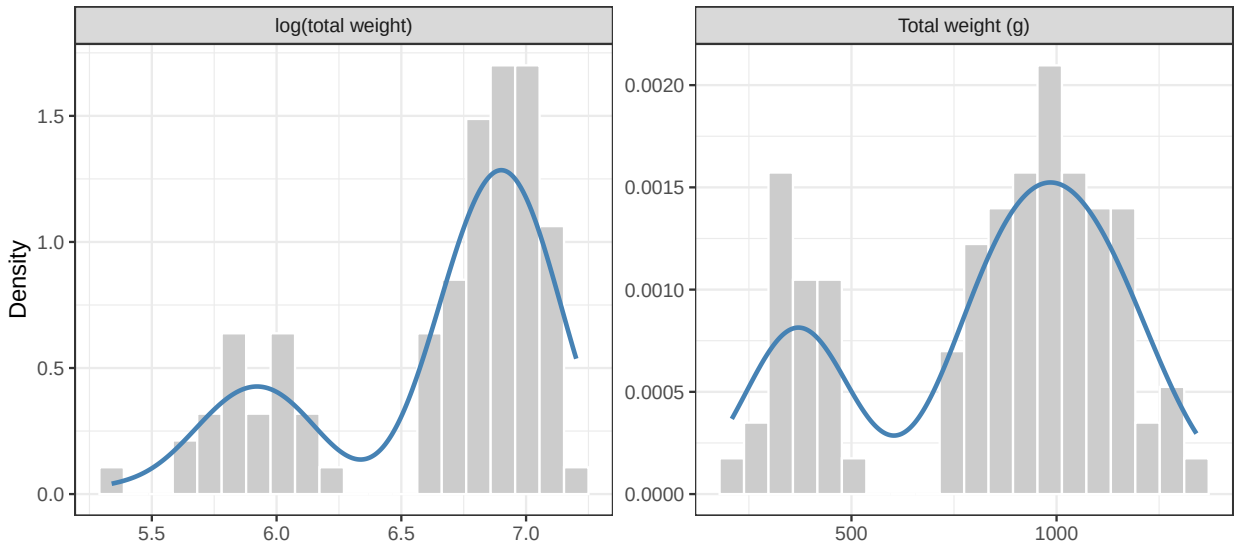


Figure 5: Total fruit weight on the raw scale (left) and the log scale (right). The raw weights are right-skewed; the log scale is closer to symmetric.

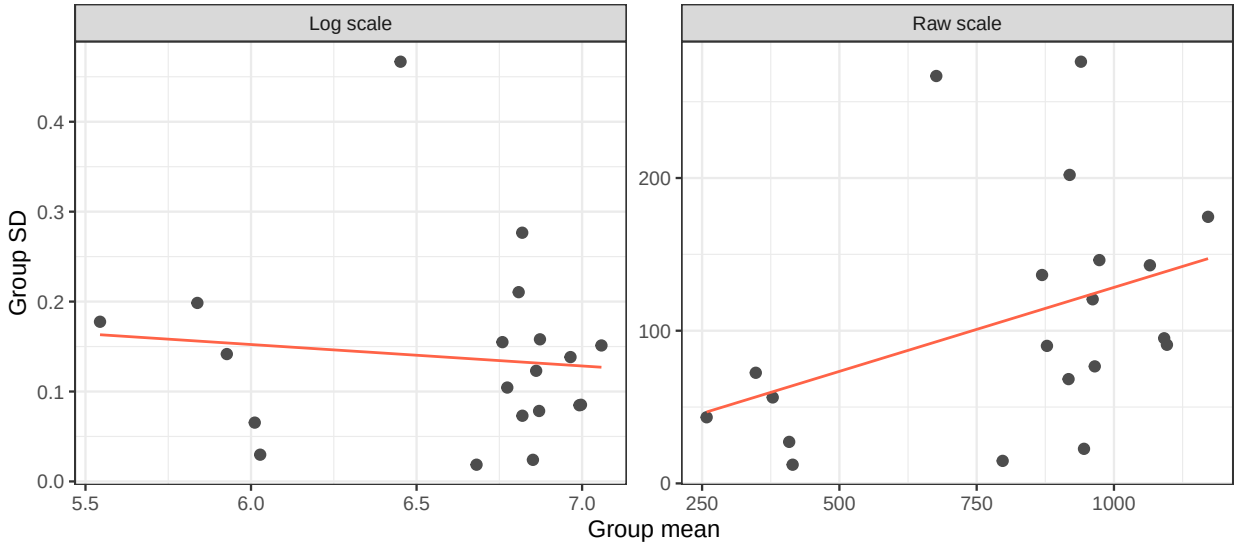


Figure 6: Group standard deviation against group mean on the raw scale (left) and the log scale (right). Each point is one cultivar, year and heat group; the line is a least-squares fit.

Logging also makes each heat effect a ratio, so a ratio of 0.80 is 20% less fruit.

Choosing the model. Five models differ only in how heat enters the fixed part, and all five keep the random intercept for pair and the cultivar-by-year shift. H0 has one heat effect. H1 lets it differ by cultivar, H2 by year, and H3 includes both interactions. H4 replaces the five-level heat group by treatment by intensity, which splits the Control plots by the intensity of their paired heated plot instead of pooling them, so it tests whether pooling is justified.

The profiles below motivate the heat-by-year term: in 2024 the heat groups are close to Control, whereas in 2025 the mean falls with the number of pulses, and Stevens is much lower in 2025 than in 2024.

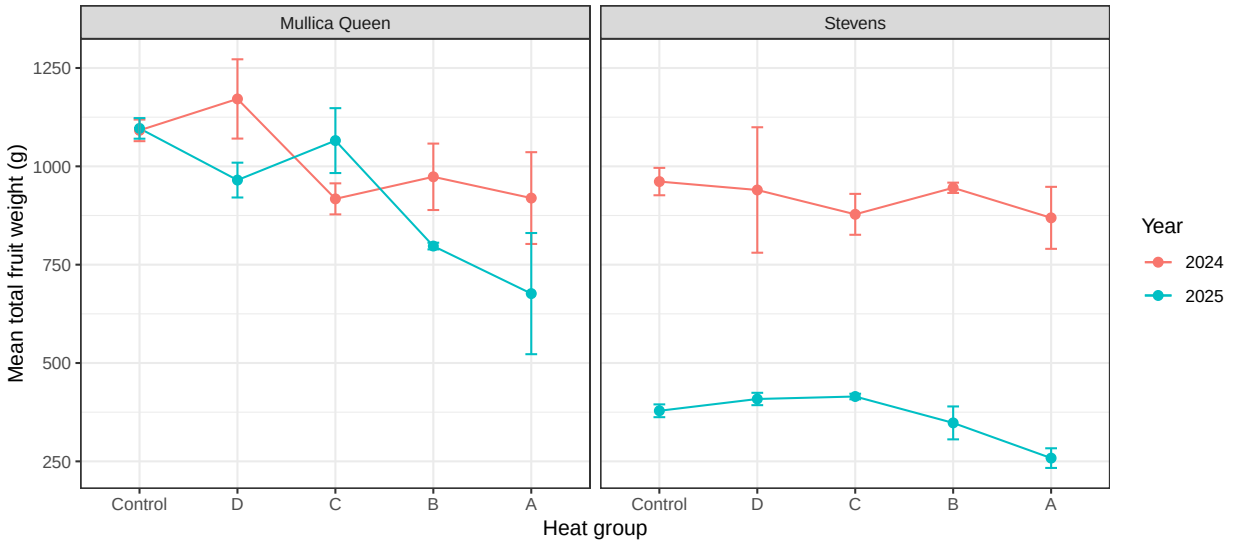


Figure 7: Mean total fruit weight by heat group and year, separately for each cultivar. In 2024 the four heat groups are close to Control; in 2025 the mean falls with the number of pulses, and Stevens is much lower than in 2024.

The candidate fixed-effect structures are:

Table 5: AIC comparison for total weight (ML fits).

Model	df	AIC	dAIC
H0	10	-71.59	13.01
H1	14	-68.64	15.96
H2	14	-84.60	0.00
H3	18	-83.69	0.91
H4	13	-66.65	17.95

```
## $cult
## Data: data
## Models:
## tw_h0: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group + cultivar + year + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## tw_h1: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * cultivar + year + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
##       npar     AIC     BIC logLik -2*log(L)  Chisq Df Pr(>Chisq)
## tw_h0   10 -71.594 -45.951 45.797   -91.594
## tw_h1   14 -68.637 -32.736 48.318   -96.637 5.0426  4      0.283
##
## $year
```

```
## Data: data
## Models:
## tw_h0: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group + cultivar + year + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## tw_h2: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * year + cultivar + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
##       npar     AIC     BIC logLik -2*log(L)  Chisq Df Pr(>Chisq)
## tw_h0   10 -71.594 -45.951 45.797   -91.594
## tw_h2   14 -84.599 -48.698 56.300  -112.599 21.005  4  0.0003159 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## $both
## Data: data
## Models:
## tw_h0: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group + cultivar + year + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## tw_h3: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * (cultivar + year) + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
##       npar     AIC     BIC logLik -2*log(L)  Chisq Df Pr(>Chisq)
## tw_h0   10 -71.594 -45.951 45.797   -91.594
## tw_h3   18 -83.688 -37.530 59.844  -119.688 28.094  8  0.0004567 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## $year_after_cult
## Data: data
## Models:
## tw_h1: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * cultivar + year + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## tw_h3: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * (cultivar + year) + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
##       npar     AIC     BIC logLik -2*log(L)  Chisq Df Pr(>Chisq)
## tw_h1   14 -68.637 -32.736 48.318   -96.637
## tw_h3   18 -83.688 -37.530 59.844  -119.688 23.052  4  0.0001237 ***
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
##
## $cult_after_year
## Data: data
## Models:
## tw_h2: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * year + cultivar + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
## tw_h3: log(total_weight) ~ heat_group * (cultivar + year) + year:cultivar + (1 | pair_id)
##       npar     AIC     BIC logLik -2*log(L)  Chisq Df Pr(>Chisq)
## tw_h2   14 -84.599 -48.698 56.300   -112.60
## tw_h3   18 -83.688 -37.530 59.844   -119.69 7.0888  4     0.1313
```

H2 has the smallest AIC, so we take H2. The likelihood-ratio tests agree: heat by year improves the fit at p = <0.001, heat by cultivar does not at p = 0.283, and adding heat by cultivar after heat by year leaves the fit unchanged at p = 0.131. H4 has a larger AIC than H2, so the Control plots can be pooled into one Control group.

A.3 Residual variance and model checks The selected model assumes one residual variance. Control and heated plots may differ in spread, so the same fixed and random effects were refitted in nlme with a separate residual variance for each group:

Residual spread. With one residual variance the residuals of heated plots are more spread out than those of Control plots. Ignoring this would make comparisons of heated plots look more precise than they are. The likelihood-ratio test of the extra variance gives p = 0.00464, and the estimated residual standard deviation of heated plots is 1.8 times that of Control plots.

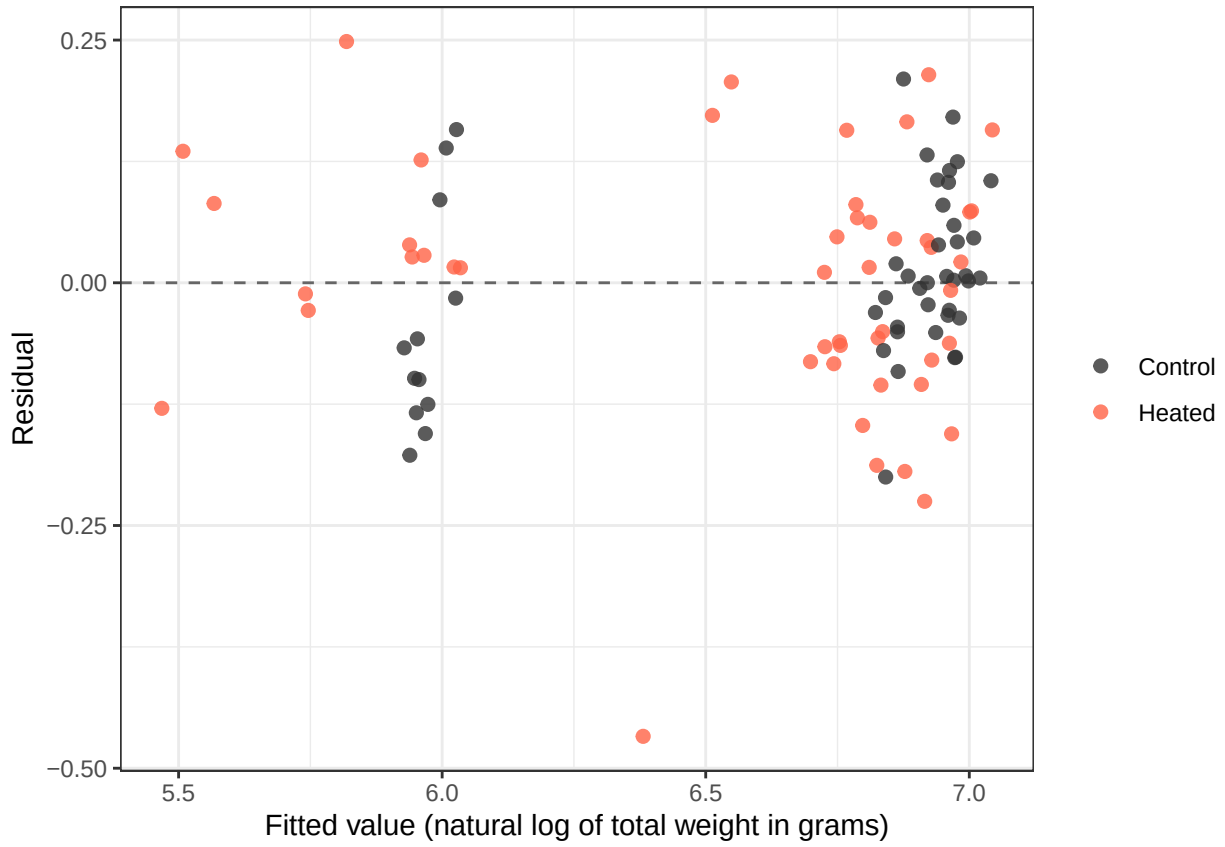


Figure 8: Residuals against fitted values from the selected model fitted with a single residual variance for all plots. Each point is one plot; black points are Control plots and red points are heated plots. The dashed line marks zero. The residuals of heated plots are clearly more spread out than those of Control plots.

After the refit the Pearson residuals and the estimated pair effects are close to normal.

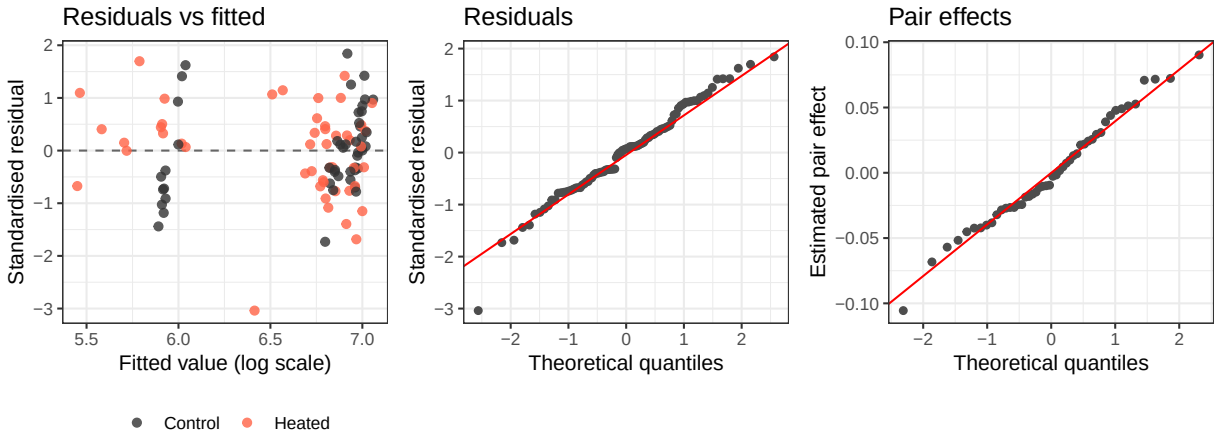


Figure 9: Diagnostic plots for the final model, which allows separate residual variances for heated and Control plots. Left: standardised (Pearson) residuals against fitted values; black points are Control plots and red points are heated plots, and the dashed line marks zero. Middle: normal quantile plot of the standardised residuals. Right: normal quantile plot of the estimated pair effects. Points close to the red lines indicate approximately normal distributions.

A.4 Sensitivity analysis We removed the 3 pairs that hold the three largest standardised residuals, 6 plots in all, and refitted the final model. The average reduction over the four heat groups is 7% in 2024 and 13% in 2025, against 8% and 15% for the full data, so the conclusions do not depend on these plots.

Appendix B: Total weight of healthy fruit (Section 4)

B.1 Model specification The final model for plot i is

$$\log(Y_i) = \mu + \alpha_{g(i)} + \beta_{t(i)} + (\alpha\beta)_{g(i)\,t(i)} + \gamma_{c(i)} + (\beta\gamma)_{t(i)\,c(i)} + b_{k(i)} + \varepsilon_i,$$

where Y_i is the healthy fruit weight in grams and log is the natural logarithm. μ is the overall intercept, α_g the effect of heat group g, β_t the effect of year t, γ_c the effect of cultivar c, $(\alpha\beta)_{gt}$ the heat-by-year interaction, and $(\beta\gamma)_{tc}$ the cultivar-by-year shift. b_k is the random intercept of pair k, with $b_k \sim N(0, \sigma_b^2)$, and ε_i is the residual error, with variance $\sigma^2_{\text{Control}}$ in Control plots and σ^2_{Heated} in heated plots. The estimated standard deviations are $\hat{\sigma}_b = 0.062$, $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Control}} = 0.093$ and $\hat{\sigma}_{\text{Heated}} = 0.212$. The model was fitted by restricted maximum likelihood in R with nlme. The estimated coefficients are in Appendix B.4.

B.2 Choice of response scale and model **Response scale.** We modelled the natural logarithm of healthy weight. On the raw scale, groups with a higher mean also varied more: the Spearman correlation between the group mean and the group standard deviation is 0.44 across the 20 cells, against -0.22 on the log scale. The log scale therefore keeps the residual spread more even.

Choosing the model. We compared six models that differ only in how heat enters the fixed part, using likelihood-ratio tests together with AIC and BIC. Heat affects healthy weight at $p < 0.001$. Letting the heat effect differ between years improves the fit at $p = 0.0064$; letting it differ between cultivars does not, $p = 0.29$. The year-specific model also has the lowest AIC. BIC penalises extra parameters more heavily and prefers the simpler common-effect model.

The year-specific heat effect mainly changes the dose response: the slope per additional pulse differs between the two years at p = 0.018, although the overall test of a year difference is only marginal at p = 0.077.

Table 6: Candidate models for the natural logarithm of healthy fruit weight. All models include cultivar, year, the cultivar-by-year interaction and a random effect for each pair, and were fitted by maximum likelihood with a single residual variance. Parameters counts all estimated quantities, including the variances. Lower AIC and BIC indicate a better balance between fit and model size. The p-value is from a likelihood-ratio test of the model against the model named in the previous column.

Model	Heat effect	Parameters	AIC	BIC	Likelihood-ratio test	p-value
1	No heat effect	6	-11.8	3.6		
2	Same heat effect in all cultivars and years	10	-46.9	-21.2	vs. model 1	< 0.001
3	Heat effect differs between cultivars	14	-43.8	-7.9	vs. model 2	0.290
4	Heat effect differs between years (selected)	14	-53.2	-17.3	vs. model 2	0.006
5	Heat effect differs between cultivars and between years	18	-51.4	-5.3	vs. model 4	0.179
6	Heat effect differs in every cultivar-year combination	22	-48.1	8.3	vs. model 5	0.324

B.3 Residual variance and model checks **Unequal variances in heated and Control plots.** When the selected model was fitted with one residual variance, the residuals of heated plots were clearly more spread out than those of Control plots. Ignoring this would understate the uncertainty of comparisons involving heated plots, so we refitted the model with separate residual variances, which fitted much better: likelihood-ratio test $p < 0.001$, and the estimated residual standard deviation of heated plots is about 2.3 times that of Control plots. With this change the residuals have a similar spread in both groups, and both the residuals and the estimated pair effects are close to normal, apart from two heated plots with unusually low healthy weight, which we examine in Appendix B.5.

B.4 Coefficients

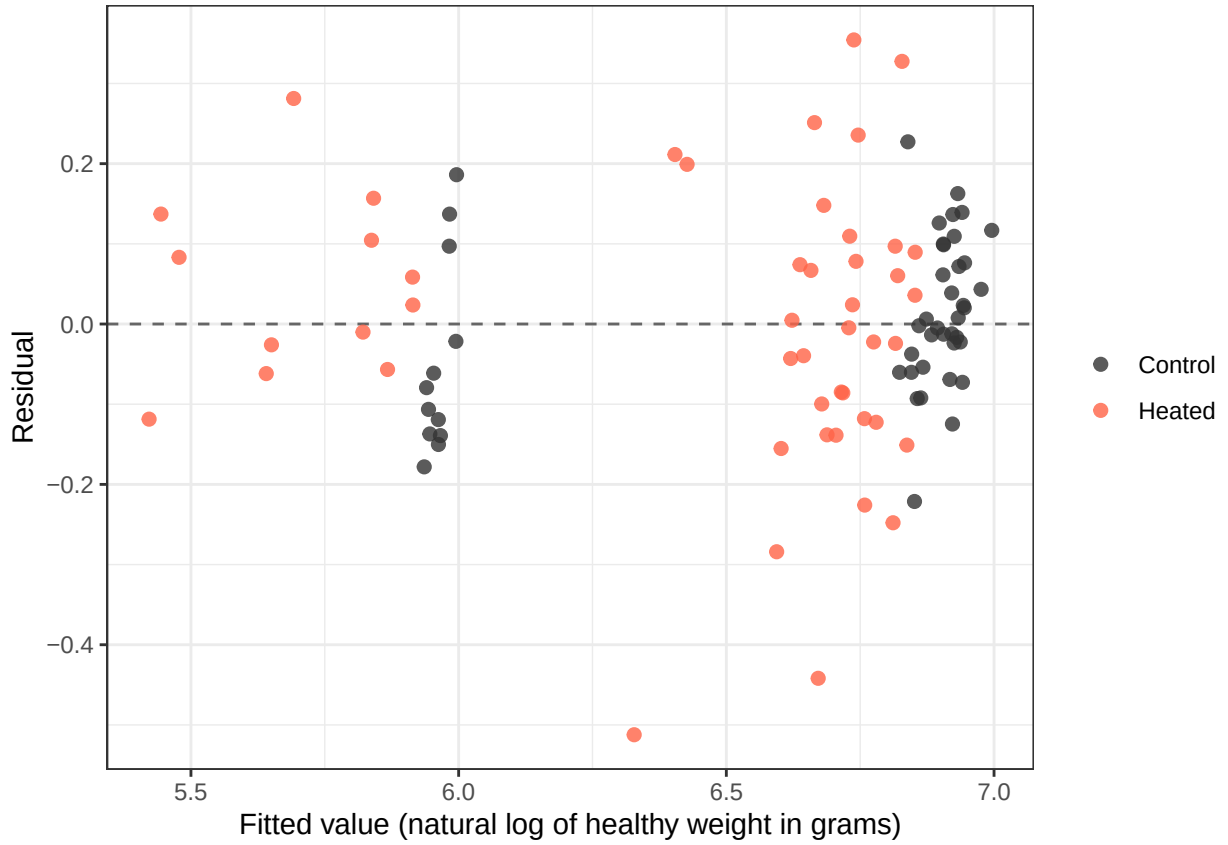


Figure 10: Residuals against fitted values from the selected model fitted with a single residual variance for all plots. Each point is one plot; black points are Control plots and red points are heated plots. The dashed line marks zero. The residuals of heated plots are clearly more spread out than those of Control plots.

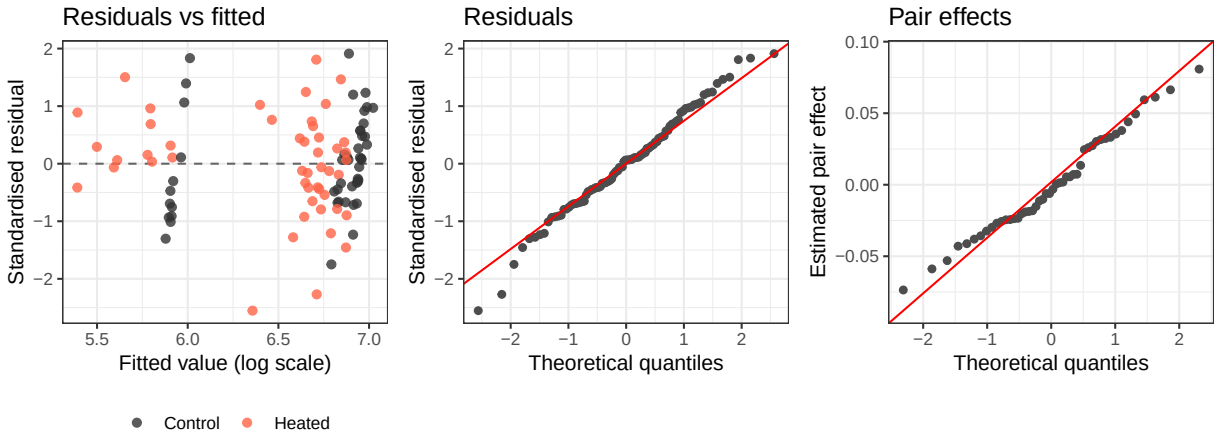


Figure 11: Diagnostic plots for the final model, which allows separate residual variances for heated and Control plots. Left: standardised (Pearson) residuals against fitted values; black points are Control plots and red points are heated plots, and the dashed line marks zero. Middle: normal quantile plot of the standardised residuals. Right: normal quantile plot of the estimated pair effects. Points close to the red lines indicate approximately normal distributions.

Table 7: Estimated fixed effects of the final model. Estimates are on the natural log scale; Ratio is the exponential of the estimate, i.e. the multiplicative change in healthy weight. The reference levels are Control, 2024 and Mullica Queen. For the intercept, the exponential is the estimated healthy weight in grams of Control plots of Mullica Queen in 2024. The heat group terms compare each heat group with Control in 2024; the terms marked × 2025 give the additional multiplicative change in 2025. The p-values are not adjusted for multiple comparisons.

Term	Estimate (log scale)	Standard error	Ratio	95% CI for ratio	p-value
Intercept (Control, 2024, Mullica Queen)	6.956	0.031	1049.56	985.47 to 1117.83	< 0.001
1 pulse	-0.178	0.091	0.84	0.70 to 1.01	0.057
2 pulses	-0.221	0.091	0.80	0.67 to 0.96	0.019
3 pulses	-0.108	0.091	0.90	0.75 to 1.08	0.239
4 pulses	-0.227	0.091	0.80	0.66 to 0.96	0.016
Year 2025	-0.012	0.044	0.99	0.90 to 1.08	0.791
Stevens	-0.105	0.043	0.90	0.83 to 0.98	0.018
1 pulse × 2025	0.061	0.128	1.06	0.82 to 1.38	0.638
2 pulses × 2025	0.146	0.128	1.16	0.89 to 1.50	0.262
3 pulses × 2025	-0.201	0.128	0.82	0.63 to 1.06	0.125
4 pulses × 2025	-0.287	0.128	0.75	0.58 to 0.97	0.031
2025 × Stevens	-0.908	0.061	0.40	0.36 to 0.46	< 0.001

B.5 Sensitivity analysis To check whether our conclusions depend on the two heated plots with unusually low healthy weight, we removed the 2 pairs that hold them, 4 plots in all, and refitted the final model. The estimated effects became slightly smaller and the main conclusions did not change: the average reduction is 14% in 2024 and 20% in 2025, and the reduction per additional pulse in 2025 is 10%. The only other change is that two heat groups in 2024 become individually discernible, which confirms that the evidence for them is borderline.